

Lori Robertson

From: Patti Rice <pr5920@gmail.com>
Sent: Tuesday, September 1, 2026 5:46 PM
To: City Council
Subject: Mariam's Cottage

Warning! External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Dear City Councilors,

I am writing to support the beautiful, new B&B on 421 E. Broadway.

Please vote yes to approve this project while supporting a small, woman owned business. This will help the local economy.

Thank you,

Patricia Rice

24 Jasper Street

Haverhill, MA

Sent from my iPhone

Lori Robertson

From: Donna Molina <missmolli48@yahoo.com>
Sent: Monday, August 24, 2026 9:39 PM
To: City Council
Subject: Miriam's Cottage

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I am writing to the City Council to show my support to keep and maintain Miriam's Cottage. I think it is very important to preserve Haverhill's history especially since this historic site has undergone such a great renovation. Please approve this bed and breakfast so the citizens of Haverhill and other communities can enjoy it and so that a precious piece of our past continues to live on. Thank you so much for reconsidering.

Donna Molina

Lori Robertson

From: Jay Stephens <jstephens138@comcast.net>
Sent: Tuesday, August 18, 2026 2:51 PM
To: City Council
Subject: B&B proposal East Broadway

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Dear City Council,

I moved to 138 E Broadway in 1989 and have watched a lot of development over the years....after years of heavy trucks hauling sand away from the sandpit.

I think it's a move in the right direction to have a place in town to enjoy the scenery and history of an old home and it's surroundings.

I wholeheartedly support the 'Bead and Breakfast' proposed on East Broadway and to be presented at the August 25 Council meeting.

Thank You,
Jay Stephens
138 East Broadway

Sent from my iPhone

Lori Robertson

From: Stephanie Dolloff <dolloff.stephanie00@gmail.com>
Sent: Tuesday, August 18, 2026 10:25 AM
To: City Council
Subject: Mariam's Cottage

Warning! External Email: Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Good morning! On Sunday I had the opportunity to view the historic property on Broadway here in Haverhill. First, let me say that Mariam and her two sons were just so welcoming. They are lovely people and good neighbors. Mariam has done a beautiful job restoring the home. Each room has been lovingly and painstakingly transformed into a serene and inviting retreat. This is in no way a party house. I envision my friends and I meeting there for a quiet little getaway. Haverhill is doing a fairly good job renewing downtown, and having small groups of visitors stay here and enjoy the fine restaurants, explore the museums, and all that Haverhill has to offer, can only be a plus for the small businesses and for attracting home buyers. Most people in the Merrimack Valley area and beyond are unaware of the many attributes of this wonderfully diverse city. I would hope that you all consider the many benefits of this historic beauty and also hope you have actually visited the property. The setting is gorgeous and there are no other homes visible or in close proximity. I'm asking you kindly and seriously to consider the possibilities of this tranquil property and grant its approval. Thank you.

Stephanie Dolloff
15 Strawberry Lane
978.809.8889

Lori Robertson

From: Bohemian Cove <bohemiancove@yahoo.com>
Sent: Monday, August 17, 2026 3:07 PM
To: City Council
Subject: RE: Support for Mariam's Cottage and Its Potential for Our Community
Attachments: 2093e4de-5e4f-4385-9119-7a685c5395dc.jfif; 4bdc2d7-57f0-4fa4-95e5-f50a67138516.jfif; 52a222eb-addd-4237-8fe2-a03a27f0ff58.jfif; e4c207cc-235d-425e-82bb-846ad5acef31.jfif; 32776bd6-bbbe-4ba4-aa0b-44a2da59d002.jfif; 1540eb29-7586-44b3-92d5-95c3dff26ef6.jfif; 9f5ea270-5640-4fe2-b772-b144a8818bad.jfif; b427194a-f674-4855-9d4f-ad025e6fe3b2.jfif; 91d03213-6c15-4a74-834c-48af2dfbf8f8.jfif

Warning! External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Dear Council Members,

I'm writing as the owner of Bohemian Cove (Haverhill's Most Unique Business 2026) to share my support for Mariam's Cottage and what I believe it could bring to Haverhill.

I recently had the opportunity to visit the property and immediately fell in love with its energy, whimsy, and charm. I've attached several photos because I think they help tell the story better than words alone.

Mariam's Cottage is not simply a bed and breakfast. It is a beautifully distinctive historic space with a whimsical Victorian feel that is truly magical. Walking through it feels a little like stepping into another time, where history, imagination, hospitality, and charm all meet.

What excites me most is the potential for collaboration.

As another local small business owner, I can already envision ways Bohemian Cove and Mariam's Cottage could work together to create unique and magical experiences for the community, such as Tea and Tarot evenings, seasonal gatherings, workshops, themed events, and other creative collaborations.

The indoor tea spaces, outdoor deck, historic character, and overall atmosphere make it the kind of place that invites people to linger, wonder, celebrate, and simply enjoy being somewhere special.

I could easily imagine guests coming to Mariam's Cottage for an experience and discovering Bohemian Cove, downtown Haverhill, our restaurants, shops, and other local businesses along the way. Likewise, my own customers and community could be introduced to Mariam's Cottage through the events and experiences we create together.

To me, supporting small businesses is not simply about commerce. At their best, small businesses are dreams made visible. They are created by people

who love what they do, who take a chance on an idea, and who invite their community to become part of that dream.

Mariam and I are both doing that in very different ways. We are each building something that began with a dream and a love for what we do.

When businesses like ours support one another, we create something bigger than either business could create alone. We create community, preserve character, encourage creativity, and give people opportunities to experience a little magic, a little joy, and the love that went into building these places in the first place.

Community is the heart of Haverhill, and I believe our small businesses are an important part of keeping that heart vibrant. They give people places to gather, discover something unexpected, share experiences, form relationships, and feel connected to the city they call home.

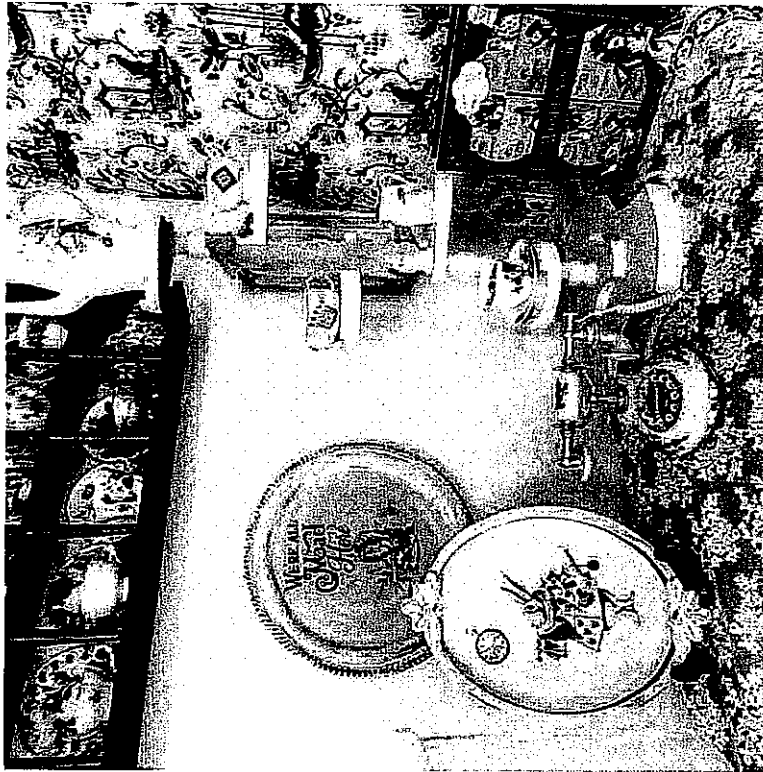
Mariam's Cottage has the potential to become much more than a place for someone to stay overnight. It can become a destination, a gathering space, and another piece of what makes Haverhill interesting and unique. Businesses with personality and imagination give people a reason to visit a community, and when those businesses collaborate, we give them reasons to come back.

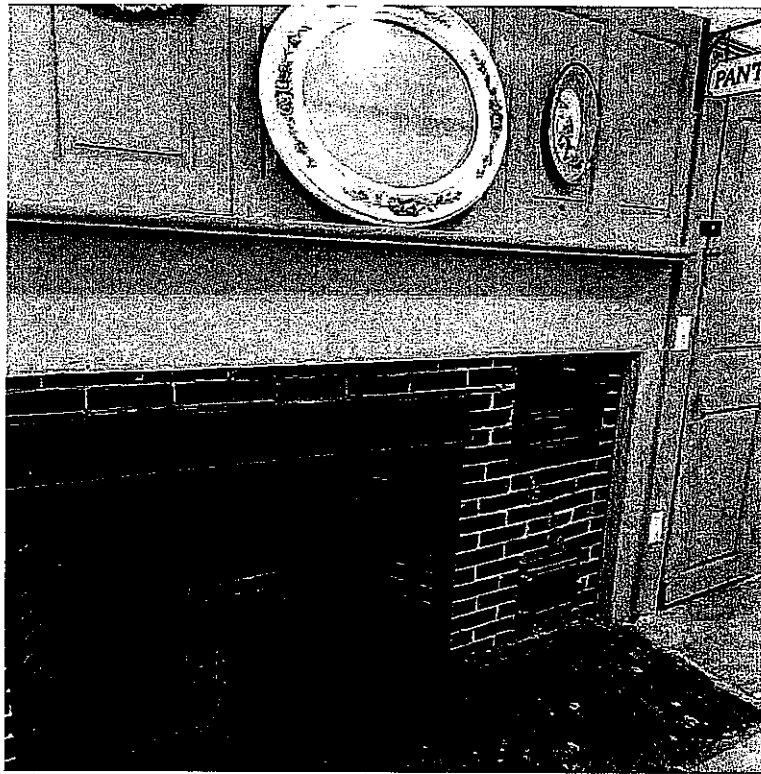
When a city supports its small businesses, it is also supporting the dreams, creativity, passion, and love of the people who are actively helping give that city its character.

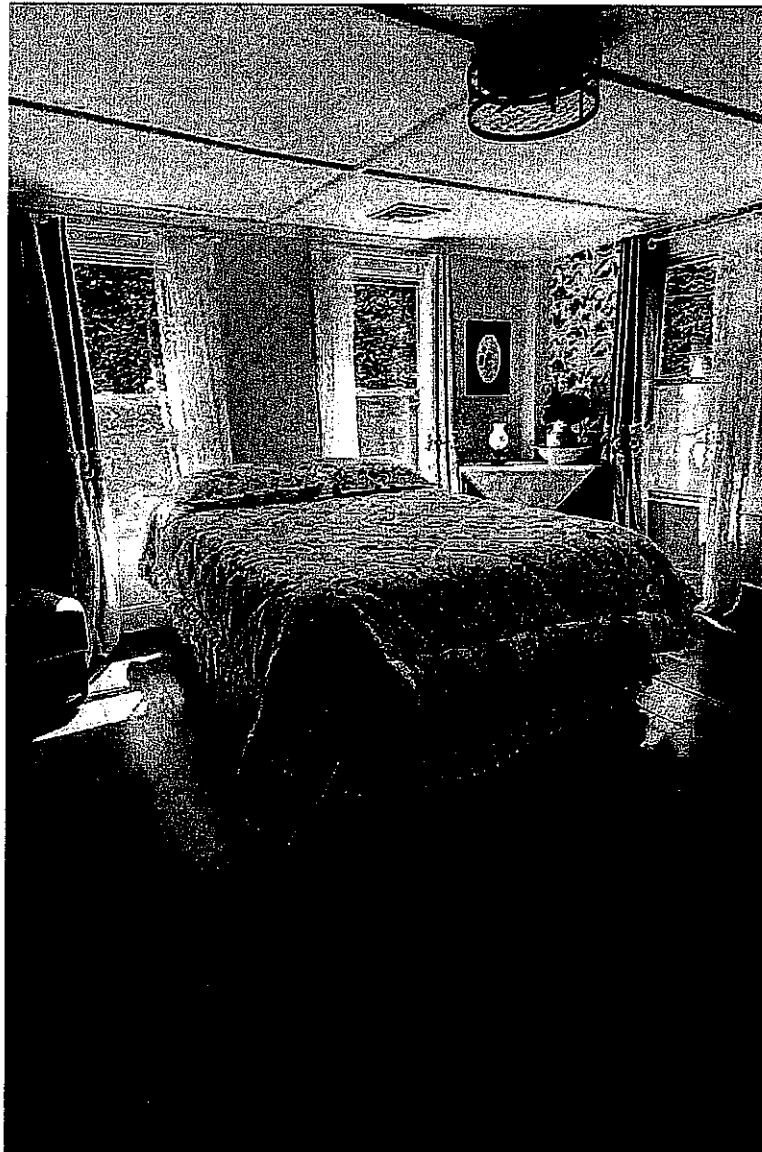
I hope you will consider not only Mariam's Cottage as a business, but the larger possibilities it creates for tourism, collaboration, community, creativity, and connection here in Haverhill.

Thank you for taking the time to consider my perspective and for supporting the people who are working to build something meaningful in our community.

Warmly,
Kristen
Owner, Bohemian Cove

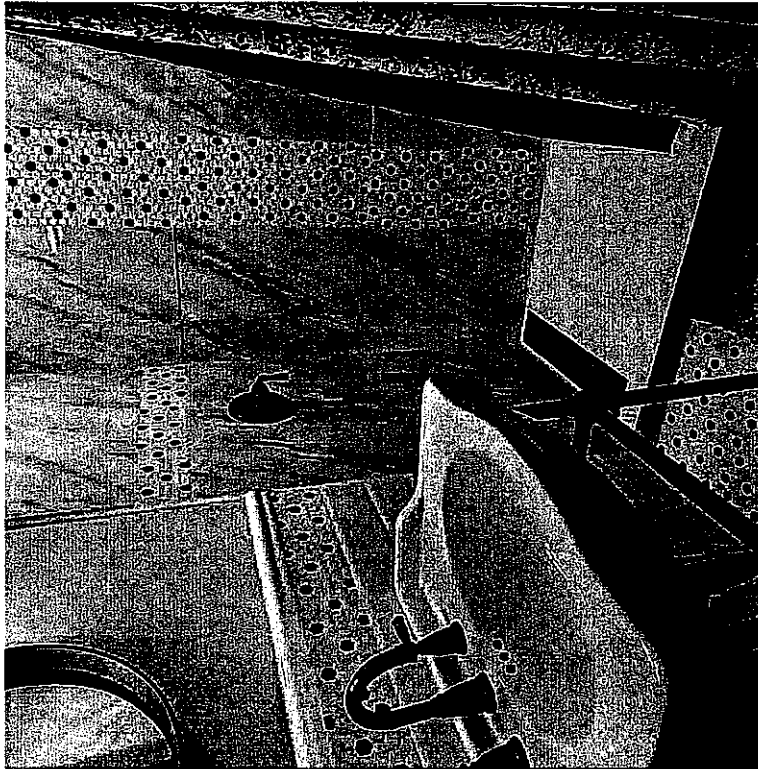




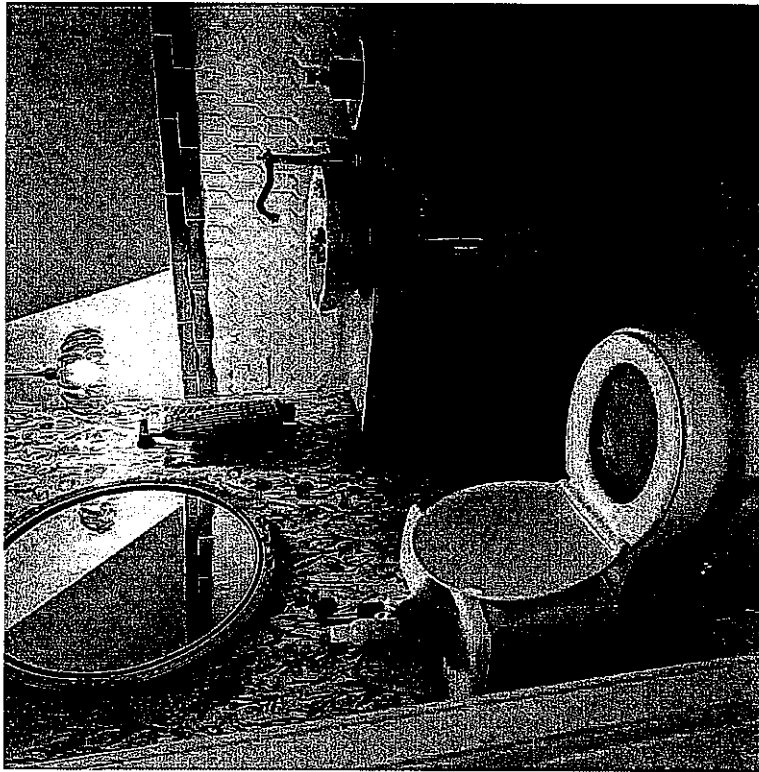


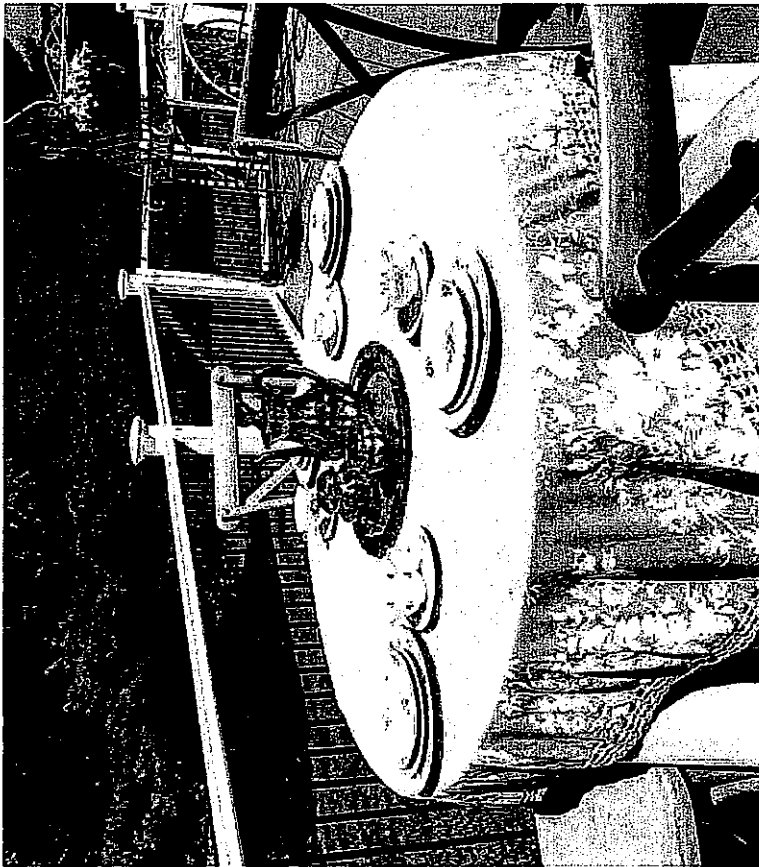












Lori Robertson

From: Di Hoffman <diloot@comcast.net>
Sent: Saturday, August 15, 2026 11:26 AM
To: City Council
Subject: Preserve history

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I say yes let this go through. What an amazing job and so much love when Into fixing this all up. 2 years too. Much better than any more condos . I vote yes and can't wait to get a tour of the inside. The outside is amazing so can't wait to make an appt to see the inside. Let's repay all her hard work and vote for this to happen. , Diane Hoffman. (Di).
Sent from my DiPhone

Lori Robertson

From: jhsmithmd@aol.com
Sent: Wednesday, August 12, 2026 12:57 PM
To: Dan Diodati; City Council
Subject: Mariam's Cottage Visit

Warning! External Email: Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Dear City Councilors,

I have a few thoughts in support of Mariam's Cottage. I visited Mariam's Cottage on Jul 21st and was very impressed with the property, the owner Mariam and her family. I feel this proposal should be seen as a potential asset to the city and not a liability.

1. The owner occupied requirement:

Seeing as how her proposal has scaled back to asking for a variance for a B&B only, I don't see her not living inside the house as a obstacle to obtaining this variance.

There is no publicly available information as to what year this owner/occupied requirement was passed (or why it was written in the first place since there are no B&Bs in Haverhill). If it was some time ago, it may have been before the onset of Ring Doorbell cameras and other technologies that assist with securing properties.

If the council is concerned about setting a precedent, I doubt there would be many (if any) future requests where the owner lives next door. Actually, the fact that she lives next door is a better scenario as compared to an Airbnb where there is no requirement the owner live in any proximity to the property or even live within the state of Massachusetts. Additionally, according to publicly available information, Haverhill has no specific Airbnb-type ordinance. Instead, Airbnb type hosts operating in the city must only abide by general local zoning rules, local health and building codes, and mandatory state-level regulations.

2. The Increased traffic concern:

As far as the concern for increase in road traffic, I understand that 1,200 cars use that road on a daily basis, with 6 accidents in 25 years. The minuscule increased traffic by B&B residents is not even an argument.

3. The concern of one abutting neighbor regarding noise:

Since there will be no outside amplified music, the only noise the neighbor might hear is perhaps the voices of a handful of people on the outside deck. The neighbor's residence is fairly far away (maybe one or two football fields away?) and is shielded by trees and other natural noise buffers. Mariam's plan to erect a fence will also aide in noise reduction.

If there is still reluctance on the part of the council to approve a variance, could the variance be subject to annual revision, renewal and approval? In other words, on a trial basis?

I think Mariam Salehi should be commended on her thoughtful and creative restoration of this historic property that showcases the beautiful landscape of Haverhill.

I strongly support the approval of a variance for Marian's Cottage to operate as a B&B.

Regards,

Joan Smith
15 Greystone Ave
Haverhill, MA

Lori Robertson

From: Roberta Small Crook <robertaacrook@gmail.com>
Sent: Wednesday, August 12, 2026 11:49 AM
To: City Council
Subject: East Broadway

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It would be lovely to have that inn on East Broadway.

If the group home that went in on Kingsbury Avenue was ok then this inn shouldn't be a problem.

Let them have it. It's a plus for the city!

Roberta A Crook

Lori Robertson

From: Allison Carvalho <allisonkcarvalho@gmail.com>
Sent: Tuesday, August 11, 2026 8:27 PM
To: City Council
Subject: Support for Mariam's Cottage Bed & Breakfast

Warning: External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Dear City Councilors,

I'm writing as a Haverhill resident to voice my support for the approval of Mariam's Cottage.

This home has deep roots in our city's history and rather than letting this piece of Haverhill's heritage sit condemned, the owners have invested in an impressive restoration to bring it back to life.

Approving this project means preserving a meaningful piece of local history while creating a small, thoughtful addition to Haverhill's economy and character. I'd be so thrilled to personally support a venue such as this.

I hope the Council will support this project when it comes up for a vote. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,
Allison

Lori Robertson

From: Jarvis, Antonette <ajarvis2@mgb.org>
Sent: Monday, August 10, 2026 11:23 AM
To: City Council
Subject: 421 E Broadway Haverhill, MA

Warning: External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Good Morning,

My husband and I had the opportunity to tour the historic home at 421 E. Broadway on Sunday, and I have to say, we were truly impressed by the property and by Maryam's vision for it. This was the first time meeting Maryam and hearing her ideas for this historical site. She is hoping to transform the home into a small B&B and I think it could be a wonderful addition to the community.

I completely understand the concerns that some neighbors may have, particularly regarding noise, traffic, and maintaining the character of the neighborhood. However, after seeing the property and hearing Maryam's plans, I feel confident that she would be extremely respectful of the surrounding neighborhood. A small B&B that caters to a limited number of guests and can be thoughtfully managed without creating significant noise or disruption.

I also think it is important to consider the history and character of the area. This property was once Henderson's farm. Kimball Farm is still an active business nearby that hosts events in the fall and welcomes visitors. I see Maryam's vision as something that could complement rather than negatively impact the neighborhood.

At the end of the day, we all have neighbors, and being a good neighbor means being respectful, considerate, and willing to work together. From what I saw on Sunday, I believe Maryam genuinely wants to do exactly that.

I really hope people will take the time to look at the proposal with an open mind. This could be an opportunity to preserve a beautiful historic property while creating something unique, welcoming, and beneficial to the community. I think the concept deserves a chance.

Respectfully,

Antonette and Robert Jarvis
9 Strawberry Lane
Haverhill, MA 01835

Antonette Jarvis
Administrative Assistant to:

David L. Perez, M.D., M.M.Sc., Chief, Division of Behavioral Neurology
Teresa Gomez-Isla, M.D., Ph.D., Chief, Division of Memory Disorders
Amanda C. Guidon, MD, MPH., Chief, Division of Neuromuscular Medicine

Lori Robertson

From: STEVEN LECOURS <steven.lecours@comcast.net>
Sent: Sunday, August 9, 2026 8:31 PM
To: City Council
Subject: 421 E. Broadway Haverhill- B&B approval

Warning! External Email: Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

To whom it may concern on the Haverhill, MA City Council-

I am writing to show my support for the approval of the request of you later this month by Miriam Sale of the property at 421 E. Broadway, Haverhill as a Bed and Breakfast establishment.

As a long-time resident of Haverhill, 25+ years, it is befitting that such a request by the current owner who worked tirelessly to restore the once condemned property be approved as a newly renovated establishment for travelers to our city near and far.

While there is some opposition toward having this sort of establishment, what I would like to impress upon you as our city council is how individuals like Ms. Salehi support what this city should be all about- preserving the charm of our city as it encourages it's cultural diversity and more importantly welcoming those into Haverhill and enable them to experience it in a such a positive way.

By approving her request, it is my opinion her establishment only further elevates the city's long-standing history in an extremely tasteful manner.

Thank you for your consideration.

Regards,

Steven LeCours
65 Leonard Avenue
Haverhill (Bradford section), MA
351-353-0127

Lori Robertson

From: Nancy Zlotsky <nzlotsky@gmail.com>
Sent: Saturday, August 8, 2026 3:17 PM
To: City Council
Subject: Mariam's Cottage: 2 cents

Warning! External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Hi City Council Members and staff,

My household (and friends) think having a B&B in Haverhill is a wonderful idea--and needed. We are a growing city with just one boring, not that nice hotel by the side of 495.

I imagine that Haverhill will be expecting more and more visitors with the Historic New England museum and events, as well as events like River Ruckus, Vintage New England, and Woofstock. Plus people have families come for NECC and Haverhill High School graduation and B&Bs are a welcome option.

I understand that the city wants most of the growth concentrated downtown, but some careful growth can also happen away from downtown, especially a small business in a lovingly restored historic home that fits with the historic vibe of Haverhill: museums like Buttonwood and the Whittier Homestead--and again what Historic New England will be offering. This is not going to be a huge apartment building or AirBnB where people are loud and party.

Some people are NIMBY but without real solid reasons for NIMBYism, there is no need to buy into it. It stalls growth, tourism, and the city's needs.

Just my 2 cents.

Nancy

Lori Robertson

From: Alison <bruyettea@yahoo.com>
Sent: Saturday, August 1, 2026 7:26 PM
To: City Council
Subject: Restored historical building

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>

> Good evening,

> I am writing to say how much I appreciate Mariam Salehi for restoring the property on 421 East Broadway. What a historical gem. I had the pleasure of touring the house. I hope you have all taken your responsibility very seriously by touring the house as well.

>

> I am 100% in favor of the proposal/project. Please approve the use of this home for overnight guests, tea parties, and bridal/baby showers.

>

> Please show the people of this city that you overwhelmingly support small businesses, that you support women owned businesses, and that you are not afraid to do the right thing.

>

> I will see you all at the next meeting, and look forward to hearing that this project will be moving forward. There is absolutely no reason that this should not happen.

>

> Thank you in advance for your yes vote.

> Respectfully,

> Alison Bruyette

> 15 Jasper St.

Lori Robertson

From: Amanda Daniels <apdaniels81@gmail.com>
Sent: Friday, July 31, 2026 7:41 PM
To: City Council
Subject: Support for the Proposed Bed & Breakfast at 421 East Broadway

Warning! External Email: Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Dear Members of the Haverhill City Council,

I am writing to express my support for the proposed bed and breakfast at 421 East Broadway.

After following the discussion surrounding this proposal, I appreciate that the Council has taken the time to carefully consider both the concerns of nearby residents and the opportunities this project could bring to Haverhill. While I understand that some neighbors have reservations about potential impacts, I believe the revised proposal deserves fair consideration based on its merits and compliance with the City's zoning requirements.

The owner, Mariam Salehi, has invested significant time and resources into restoring a historic property that had previously fallen into disrepair. Preserving and giving new life to historic homes is something that benefits our entire community. A thoughtfully operated bed and breakfast has the potential to attract visitors, support local restaurants and businesses, and showcase Haverhill's history and charm without fundamentally changing the character of the neighborhood.

I also believe projects like this contribute to a more vibrant local economy. While there are understandably mixed opinions in our community regarding the pace of new apartment complexes and large-scale commercial developments, a small, locally owned bed and breakfast represents a different kind of growth—one that highlights historic preservation, small business ownership, and tourism rather than large-scale development.

I encourage the Council to continue evaluating the proposal thoughtfully and to support a path forward. I believe this project has the potential to become a unique asset for Haverhill while respecting the surrounding neighborhood.

Thank you for your time, your service to our community, and your careful consideration of this matter.

Sincerely,
Amanda Daniels
21 Westford Street

Lori Robertson

From: Zach Soto <zszachz@gmail.com>
Sent: Tuesday, July 28, 2026 4:53 PM
To: City Council
Subject: Bed And Breakfast in Haverhill

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Hello city council,

It has come to my attention that some fellow residents and I are in large support of a BNB within our city. I find it a very reasonable request as we are clearly showing signs of growing as a city, both downtown and the surrounding areas.

With this new opportunity to have a bed and breakfast in Haverhill, it will allow for a nice touch of respite for those traveling or wanting a place in the city without that downtown city feel.

Where it is being requested has ample space for it to be done, plenty of room for opportunities and potential expansions as well. I don't see why having this fine establishment be added to the city would be a problem at all!

I wish this to be forwarded to every council member in attendance to show them that not only myself, but other fully support this idea as it would bring a small slice of traditional Americana to the ever growing city!

Cheers,
Zach

ASHLEIGH BERGH

59 W Rochambault Street • Haverhill, MA 01832 • 978-241-2607 • ashleigh.bergh@gmail.com

July 27, 2026

To the Members of the Haverhill City Council

Haverhill City Hall
4 Summer Street
Haverhill, MA 01830

AUG 11 AM 11:40
HVCITYCLERK

Re: Letter of Support — Proposed Bed & Breakfast at 421 E Broadway

Dear Members of the Haverhill City Council,

My name is Ashleigh Bergh. I am a proud, second-generation Hillie — born and raised here in Haverhill, and a graduate of Haverhill Public Schools and Haverhill High School's class of 2006. My first job was here in Haverhill; about ten years ago, I worked for a short time at the Greater Haverhill Chamber of Commerce. A little over a year ago, my husband and I purchased a home on W Rochambault Street. After living in North Carolina for six years, we were proud to come back to our roots and make Haverhill our permanent home once again.

Since graduating in 2006, I have lived in various parts of the country and visited many more. What I have consistently found is this: the places that lack history and charm are spending real money trying to *manufacture* it to attract visitors and residents — while the places that successfully balance preserving their history with building their future do so by having the courage to embrace something new.

Although I write to you as a proud resident, I write today specifically as a small business owner. I have been a travel advisor for nine-plus years, working with clients on trips of all shapes and sizes — everything from three weeks in Europe to a long weekend a short drive away. That work gives me a particular vantage point on what this proposal represents.

Why the timing for this is right

Across the travel industry, 2026 is already shaping up to be a year of record lows due to a range of economic and socio-political factors, and 2027 is beginning to show the same. But the flip side — or, as I prefer to see it, the *opportunity* — is that local, “stay-cation” and mini-trip travel is rapidly gaining popularity. When air travel pushes even most domestic trips out of budget, travelers prioritize destinations within a few hours’ drive. People still want to get away; they are simply refocusing on what’s closer to home — often a place they’d taken for granted until now.

Well-established municipalities in our region are ready for that demand. Take a twenty-minute drive in any direction and you’ll find recognized brand hotels in North Andover, Salem NH, and Amesbury. Haverhill has one such hotel, soon to be two. But what all of these have in common is precisely what makes *this* proposal unique: they are brand hotels located directly off major interstates, built to serve people passing through. That market is already met. What is *not* met is the option for the traveler who says, “I don’t want to just pass through; I want to be a part of a community during my stay.”

ASHLEIGH BERGH

59 W Rochambault Street • Haverhill, MA 01832 • 978-241-2607 • ashleigh.bergh@gmail.com

Just recently, I spoke with an acquaintance traveling from New York City to celebrate her bachelorette party this September. The weekend's festivities are centered in Salem, MA — but the cost of staying local to Salem proved too high, so the group is staying at an Airbnb here in Haverhill and intends to drive 45-plus minutes each way to their activities. She has already asked me for recommendations on Haverhill restaurants and things to do while they're here. That is a group coming to our region to celebrate a major life milestone, priced out of the obvious market, spending their money and attention on *our* city instead — almost by accident. These are the quiet opportunities that already exist all around us. We simply need the willingness to take a small, thoughtful risk to let them blossom.

The problem with small-event spaces in Haverhill

During my time at the Chamber in 2015–2016, one challenge in event planning stood out above all others: a shortage of *right-sized* spaces to host events. At the time, the majority of Haverhill's event spaces were designed for larger functions, and to this day that remains the case — most venues within a two-to-three-mile radius of Downtown are built for 100-plus guests. Those spaces meet a real need. But for smaller gatherings of 50 people or fewer, they either price the smaller group out entirely or are booked solid during the busiest times of year. The result is that those hosts take their events — and their money — elsewhere, a loss of both revenue and exposure for the city.

The real size of this proposal

The bed and breakfast at the heart of this proposal would offer four guest rooms, sized for double occupancy — a maximum of roughly eight overnight guests at full capacity. This is not a hotel's worth of traffic; it is a handful of cars on a quiet night. It is also a business housed inside a historic home that this owner painstakingly restored — a home that, absent their investment, would have been left to deteriorate. Restoring and reactivating that property protects a piece of Haverhill's character *and* returns it to the tax base as a productive, revenue-generating asset.

I understand that neighbors have raised concerns about noise and traffic, and I take those concerns seriously. I'd like to offer some perspective on both.

On *traffic*: a gathering of 30 to 50 people is far closer to “a neighbor hosting a family birthday party” than to a sprawling all-day event. Guests arrive and depart within one clustered window, and any event would have a defined start and end time — not the steady, all-day churn of a large wedding. In my experience, it is standard practice for a business hosting events to provide parking guidance and transportation recommendations well in advance; where parking is at a premium, venues have communicated to guests early and clearly that carpooling and rideshare are strongly encouraged. A professional operator manages arrivals; they don't leave them to chance.

I would also gently remind the council that this stretch of road is no stranger to gatherings. Kimball Farm, just down the same road and accessible only via that same route, has long hosted one-time and seasonal events — and, as I understand it, over a wider range of hours, with more comings and goings than a

ASHLEIGH BERGH

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defined-window private event would generate. I raise this not to cast Kimball Farm in any negative light — quite the opposite; it's a beloved neighbor! I raise it only because there is likely a real, existing history of traffic on this road that the council can examine. The *assumed* increase in traffic may prove far less tangible than feared once measured against what the area already absorbs.

My suggestion: start small and let it prove itself

I understand the council has asked the owner to return with a revised proposal focused on the bed and breakfast. I want to encourage the council not to view this as an all-or-nothing decision, but as an opportunity to begin sensibly and expand on evidence.

Rather than write off the broader vision, I would ask the council to consider approving the bed and breakfast along with small *indoor* events now, under a short set of common-sense conditions:

- Indoor events only during this initial period, with outdoor gatherings set aside until there is a real track record to evaluate.
- A firm nightly end time. Because Haverhill already has a noise ordinance in place, an agreed-upon end time is a reasonable and easily enforced condition — one that speaks directly to any neighbors' concern.

One further point on those concerns: it isn't clear to me whether the initial proposal included any intent to obtain a liquor license. If it did, I understand entirely why an abutter would worry that events where alcohol is served could raise both noise and safety concerns — and I would respectfully ask that the council fold a condition governing the service of alcohol into this same set of guardrails. If, on the other hand, no liquor license was requested and there is no current intent to pursue one, then that particular concern is moot, and I'd simply ask that it not be treated as a problem where none exists.

From there, allow the owner to operate, build a genuine track record, and return to the council in the future to make the case for outdoor or expanded events — backed by real operating history rather than speculation on either side.

I would respectfully suggest *against* attaching a fixed expiration date to this arrangement. A hard deadline risks becoming a target and an invitation for a determined few to generate complaints simply to run out the clock. Far better to let the business earn its future on its actual merits, measured over time.

The larger opportunity here

The new Haverhill Center at the Historic New England building will draw visitors from across New England — and, in time, well beyond — to this area. As that Center grows into an attraction, those visitors will need places to stay. And if you are someone drawn to the history of New England, would you not want to sleep in an *actual* historic home in the very city you came to explore? This B&B is precisely the kind of lodging our heritage-tourism investment currently lacks.

ASHLEIGH BERGH

59 W Rochambault Street • Haverhill, MA 01832 • 978-241-2607 • ashleigh.bergh@gmail.com

I say this as someone who would put it into practice. I would readily refer and book my own clients into a property like this — specifically the travelers drawn to local history and immersion. These are the guests who aren't looking for a Marriott. They're the ones who love knowing the eggs at breakfast came from the farm just down the road, and who want a charming, cozy place to return to after a full day of exploring all our area offers. The word-of-mouth that kind of experience generates is something you simply cannot buy.

Before I close

I offer myself as an ongoing resource to the council — I am glad to speak at a hearing, or to share my industry perspective whenever it may be useful. And while my support here is specific to this proposal, my larger hope speaks to how Haverhill approaches its economic development altogether: with the confidence to embrace something new, and the determination not to be left behind. The places that thrive are the ones willing to take a small, well-considered risk on an idea before it's obvious. This is one of those ideas.

Thank you for your time, your service, and your thoughtful consideration.

Respectfully, your neighbor,
Ashleigh

Ashleigh Bergh
59 W Rochambault St
Haverhill, MA 01832

Lori Robertson

From: Cathy <Cathy@Rotem-inc.com>
Sent: Monday, July 27, 2026 2:26 PM
To: City Council
Subject: B&B

Warning: External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Good afternoon,

I am writing in support of the B&B that is on the docket for a vote.

I have stayed at several B&B's over the years and have always found them to be filled with history of the town or city that they reside in, the accommodations have always been exceptional, and the service was always pleasant. Allowing a B&B to open in Haverhill will not only help in bringing out of towners to our little corner of the state, but to allow them to either travel to the beaches that we have to offer or the beautiful mountains just hours away and lets not forget the awesome restaurants that we have.

I also feel that allowing the owner to host such events as: High Tea, bridal and baby showers and on a smaller scale, intimate weddings should be taken into consideration as well. I have read several posts on the Bridal pages that I subscribe to, the bride is either looking for a small, scaled quant farm location for a small wedding, a few have requested a B&B that could accommodate a Justice of the Peace Wedding as well as a place to stay.

This is just my 2 cents worth, but I would hate to see that the city couldn't come to an agreement for a B&B due to parking issues., it is not like there is going to be a traffic issue on a daily basis.

Regards

Cathy Bergh
15 Forest Ave
Haverhill, MA

Lori Robertson

From: Devan Ferreira
Sent: Friday, July 24, 2026 11:52 AM
To: Lori Robertson
Subject: Fw: Special Permit for 421 East Broadway

Hi Lori!

Can this be uploaded to the portal with the other letters of support? I don't think it was sent to the city council general email?

Devan Ferreira

she/her
City Councilor for Haverhill's Ward 3
(401)499-3583

JUL 28 AM 11:07
HVCITYCLERK

From: Cindy McKallagat <fitzarella@hotmail.com>
Sent: Saturday, 18 July 2026 20:09:40
To: Tim Jordan <tjordan@haverhillma.gov>; John Michitson <JMichitson@haverhillma.gov>; Colin LePage <clepage@haverhillma.gov>; Ralph T. Basiliere <RBasiliere@haverhillma.gov>; Thomas J. Sullivan <tsullivan@haverhillma.gov>; Dan Diodati <DDiodati@HaverhillMa.gov>; Devan Ferreira <DFerreira@haverhillma.gov>; Melissa Lewandowski <mlewandowski@haverhillma.gov>; Shaun Toohey <stoohy@haverhillma.gov>; Michael McGonagle <mmcgonagle@HaverhillMa.gov>; Catherine Rogers <crogers@haverhillma.gov>
Subject: Special Permit for 421 East Broadway

Warning! External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Dear Members of the Haverhill City Council,

I am writing in support of the request for a special permit to operate the proposed business at 421 East Broadway.

As a Haverhill resident who is familiar with East Broadway, I believe this property is well suited for the type of small event venue being proposed. Haverhill has many venues designed for larger, more expensive events, but there are relatively few options for smaller, more intimate gatherings. This location could provide a welcoming space for bridal and baby showers, birthday and retirement celebrations, cooking classes, small business meetings, and similar events.

After listening to the City Council meeting and reading comments from members of the public, I understand that some neighbors have concerns. While those concerns deserve consideration, it appears that many have already been addressed or could be resolved through reasonable permit conditions.

Regarding noise, the property's natural surroundings provide significant buffering. Dense woods lie directly across the street with no homes opposite the venue, and a substantial tree line borders the neighboring property and extends toward the river. Given the proposed limit on attendance, I believe noise would be minimal. In addition, the deck primarily faces the owner's property rather than neighboring homes, further reducing the potential impact.

The type of business being proposed is also important to consider. This is not a venue likely to attract large late-night parties. Instead, it is intended for smaller, well-managed gatherings such as showers, family celebrations, workshops, and business events. As I understand it, the owner plans to be present during events to oversee operations, assist with organization and catering, and address any issues should they arise.

Traffic also appears to be a manageable concern. Based on information presented by the Police Department, the proposed venue is not expected to create a significant traffic impact. Compared with the existing traffic generated by construction vehicles, motorcycles, and commuters traveling to and from Whittier Regional Vocational Technical High School and Northern Essex Community College, the additional traffic from occasional events of fewer than 50 guests would likely be relatively minor.

Parking also appears to have been thoughtfully addressed, with adequate on-site parking provided for guests.

I also encourage the Council to consider the economic realities of operating a small business. While reasonable conditions are appropriate, restrictions that severely limit attendance or the number of events could make it difficult for the business to succeed. Mrs. Yamin has demonstrated a willingness to work with the City and neighboring residents by modifying her proposal and addressing concerns as they have been raised.

I respectfully ask that you consider granting the special permit. I believe this business would provide a valuable service to the community while having minimal impact on the surrounding neighborhood. It would offer Haverhill residents another option for hosting small, meaningful gatherings and support local entrepreneurship in the process.

Thank you for your time, consideration, and service to our community.

Sincerely,

Cynthia McKallagat

Lori Robertson

From: Devan Ferreira
Sent: Friday, July 24, 2026 11:53 AM
To: Lori Robertson
Subject: Fw: Special Permit Request for East Broadway

Same for this one

Devan Ferreira

she/her
City Councilor for Haverhill's Ward 3
(401)499-3583

From: mmmmpd@comcast.net <mmmmpd@comcast.net>
Sent: Friday, 10 July 2026 13:49:03
To: Tim Jordan <tjordan@haverhillma.gov>; John Michitson <JMichitson@haverhillma.gov>; Colin LePage <clepage@haverhillma.gov>; Ralph T. Basiliere <RBasiliere@haverhillma.gov>; Thomas J. Sullivan <tsullivan@haverhillma.gov>; Dan Diodati <DDiodati@HaverhillMa.gov>; Devan Ferreira <DFerreira@haverhillma.gov>; Melissa Lewandowski <mlewandowski@haverhillma.gov>; Shaun Toohey <stoohey@haverhillma.gov>; Michael McGonagle <mmcgonagle@HaverhillMa.gov>; Catherine Rogers <crogers@haverhillma.gov>
Subject: Special Permit Request for East Broadway

Warning! External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Dear Members of the City Council,

I am writing to express my strong support for the issuance of a special permit for the proposed small event venue on East Broadway in Haverhill.

As someone who has lived in this city my entire life and currently resides on East Broadway, I believe it would be a positive addition to our city.

Our community has a need for a small, intimate venue where residents can host baby showers, bridal showers, birthday celebrations, anniversary parties, family reunions and other smaller gatherings. After attending the last city council meeting regarding this issue, it appeared to me that the owner has carefully considered her business plan as well as the concerns for the neighborhood-i.e.-traffic impact study, limited number of guests, parking, reasonable evening operating hours, etc. Throughout this process she has demonstrated her willingness to listen, make adjustments, reduce the scope of the project and offer reasonable concessions. I believe her willingness to compromise speaks volumes as to the type of business owner she will be.

I would ask the council however to take into consideration the practical realities of operating a business when suggesting a limit of the number of guests attending a gathering. Many of you, as business owners yourselves, understand that any business must have a certain amount of activity in order to cover expenses and to be viable. Reasonable restrictions seem appropriate but to limit gatherings to an unrealistically small number of people will make it difficult for the venue to succeed financially. During the meeting the owner seemed willing to adjust the number from 50 to 25. If I reserved this venue for a gathering my family members alone, without inviting friends, would exceed the 25 limit. To propose a lower number than 25 would seem unrealistic for the operation of this venue.

Supporting responsible small business in our community is an investment in our city's future . This proposal offers residents another local option for celebrating life's special occasions while contributing positively to our local economy.

Thank you to the Council members that were in favor of this proposal. Many others seemed that they would be open to granting the special permit with some adjustments to the proposal. Hopefully this is the case and the council will grant the permit and allow this project to move forward.

Respectfully,
Pam Daggett

Lori Robertson

From: Devan Ferreira
Sent: Friday, July 24, 2026 11:52 AM
To: Lori Robertson
Subject: Fw: East Broadway B&B

Same for this one?

Devan Ferreira

she/her
City Councilor for Haverhill's Ward 3
(401)499-3583

From: Alison Colby-Campbell <alisonsbrain4rent@gmail.com>
Sent: Friday, 17 July 2026 09:38:25
To: Catherine Rogers <crogers@haverhillma.gov>; Thomas J. Sullivan <tsullivan@haverhillma.gov>; Tim Jordan <tjordan@haverhillma.gov>; John Michitson <JMichitson@haverhillma.gov>; Dan Diodati <DDiodati@HaverhillMa.gov>; Colin LePage <clepage@haverhillma.gov>; Ralph T. Basiliere <RBasiliere@haverhillma.gov>; Devan Ferreira <DFerreira@haverhillma.gov>; Melissa Lewandowski <mlewandowski@haverhillma.gov>; Shaun Toohey <stoohey@haverhillma.gov>; macanddrealty@gmail.com <macanddrealty@gmail.com>
Subject: East Broadway B&B

Warning: External Email: Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links

Dear Councillors,

I am writing to express my overwhelming support of Maryam Salehi-Ala's proposal to open her charming B&B on E. Broadway.

I've visited the property twice and find it difficult to see what issues have not been met by the property owners. Maryam seems to accommodate every request placed on her and yet each time she does someone adds something else to try and thwart what I feel will be an asset to the City. At this point, the negative responses I've read online and heard seem to be manufactured from conjecture, and the deliberate spread of misinformation.

She has the parking, she lives next door and so is invested in maintaining a positive environment for herself and family as well as the neighbors. She's taken a dangerous eyesore and made it into a calm and beautiful oasis keeping in the spirit of the neighborhood and its history. It is an ornately and delicately decorated property with beautiful landscaping. This property after years of neglect now incites meditation and reflection not raucous mobs and rock concerts. In fact she's agreed to no amplified music outdoors. She's limited the dates it could be open.

We want beautiful things to bring people to Haverhill, we say we support business (I hope that includes small business like this), we want people to understand that Haverhill is more than a vibrant downtown. Haverhill should feel lucky and proud to promote this as a unique part of the Haverhill aesthetic.

If one were to say that since I don't live nearby it wouldn't affect me, I would respectfully disagree. Anything that better the City is a boon for all. Additionally, I would appreciate having such a lovely spot to house visiting family.

Please vote to make Haverhill more beautiful and outstanding by allowing this B&B.

Thank you for your consideration,
Alison Colby-Campbell
112 Farrwood Dr, Bradford, MA 01835

Alison's Brain4Rent
Media, Marketing & Pizzazz (and Photos, too)
Telephone: 978.376.9859

[Alison Colby-Campbell on LinkedIn](#)
[Haverhill Life Contributing Writer/Photographer](#)
[Salem Life Contributing Writer/Photographer](#)
[Alison Colby-Campbell Photography](#)
[AlisonsBrain4Rent Blog](#)
[The Heartbeat of Haverhill Blog and TheHeartbeatofHaverhill Facebook Page](#)

Dear Members of the City Council,

My name is Phil Rice, I reside at 427 East Broadway next door to Maryam, Nikka, Sherwin and Arash Yamin, owners of the property at 421 East Broadway. And I write in support of their petition to the Council for a special permit to operate a bed and breakfast at this location.

Regarding the bed and breakfast it offers travelers something they can't get from large hotels or crowded tourist hubs, authentic peace and connection. Many people want to escape the noise of daily life, and a countryside setting naturally provides quiet, scenic surroundings that help them unwind. Pair that with the warm, personal touch of a Bed and Breakfast

Rural areas also tend to have lower operating costs, which means you can offer a high-quality stay without the large overhead. And because travelers increasingly seek out unique, local experiences—farm stays, nature retreats, small-town charm—a rural B&B can stand out in a way that chain hotels simply can't. And provide Haverhill's smaller business with a new revenue of income.

This home is already multi bedroom, and has 3 bedrooms, it could at anytime, accumulate as many as six cars there. As a B&B most couples come in 1 car, at capacity there would be only 3 cars one of which would be the owner occupied vehicle. This would not significantly increase traffic. This home is not very close to the nearest neighbor.

This B&B should be viewed more as a residential business like the few other residential businesses that have been in the same area.

Maryam has a warm very personal character. She goes out of her way to be friendly coming by to drop of her homemade cakes, pies, cookies etc. she keeps her own property covered with flowers, bushes, vegetable garden and manicured lawn. She totally refurbished the total house which was in total despair when she bought it. We (Phil & Darlene Rice), reside at 427 east Broadway for 50 years and couldn't have had a better neighbor. And definitely support our neighbor and friend for this endeavor.

Philip Rice

 3/17/26

Dear Members of City Council,

I am a neighbor of 421 E. Broadway. After discussing the plans, I believe that a bed and breakfast is a beneficial use of the property and will positively impact the neighborhood. In addition to the usual overnight visitors, I understand and support the use of the property for small-scale gatherings.

I request that the Council grant the petition for a bed and breakfast with any reasonable conditions that the Council believes are necessary for the operation of a bed and breakfast on the property.

Thank you,

Nikra Yamin

M. SALEH IAH

423.E. Broadway

Dear Members of City Council,

I am a neighbor of 421 E. Broadway. After discussing the plans, I believe that a bed and breakfast is a beneficial use of the property and will positively impact the neighborhood. In addition to the usual overnight visitors, I understand and support the use of the property for small-scale gatherings.

I request that the Council grant the petition for a bed and breakfast with any reasonable conditions that the Council believes are necessary for the operation of a bed and breakfast on the property.

Thank you,

 Alexander Burke

7/6/22/26

435 E Broadway

Dear Members of City Council,

I am a neighbor of 421 E. Broadway. After discussing the plans, I believe that a bed and breakfast is a beneficial use of the property and will positively impact the neighborhood. In addition to the usual overnight visitors, I understand and support the use of the property for small-scale gatherings.

I request that the Council grant the petition for a bed and breakfast with any reasonable conditions that the Council believes are necessary for the operation of a bed and breakfast on the property.

Thank you,

Scott W. Sel

418 E. Broadway
Averhill MA

Dear Members of the City Council,

I am a neighbor of Maryam, Nikka, Sherwin, and Arash Yamin, owners of the property at 421 East Broadway, and I write in support of their petition to the Council for a special permit to operate a bed and breakfast at this location. Maryam is a kind, thoughtful and passionate individual. An example of this would be after just meeting, she attended an art show of mine to support me.

I have lived at 413 East Broadway since 2001 and live two houses from 421 East Broadway, close enough to see the property directly from my window.

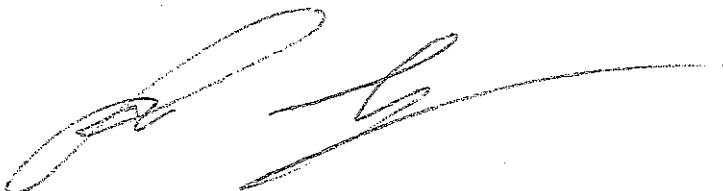
Before moving into my house, I spent a week in 421 E. Broadway in 2001 and even at that time the property was not updated to its full potential. I unfortunately have witnessed it fall into worse condition over the past 25+ years. Renters destroyed the property several years back and ultimately, this caused the house to be condemned.

Since purchasing the property, I have seen the years of work the Yamin's have put into it, to give it new life. As an artist, I especially appreciate the care, creativity, and thoughtful design she has brought to the space. You can see through the attention to detail that Maryam has approached this project as a steward of the home and its history, with a genuine desire to share that story and create meaningful experiences for guests. It is more than simply a place to stay—through the culinary experiences and creative activities Maryam hopes to offer, it is a small cultural retreat. This type of immersive experience is not available anywhere else (that I am aware of) not even in neighboring towns. I believe it would be a wonderful and unique asset to our neighborhood.

I understand and fully support the use of the property for small gatherings of up to 50 guests; this is another feature that can make the property even more special for the community.

For these reasons, I request that the Council grant Maryam and her children's petition for a special permit, with any reasonable conditions the Council believes are appropriate for the operation of a bed and breakfast at this property.

Best,
Denise Chesky

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Denise Chesky', with a long horizontal flourish extending to the right.

781-718-9361
ddelongis@gmail.com

Haverhill City Council
Haverhill City Hall
4 Summer Street
Haverhill MA, 01830

Re: Letter of Support for Bed & Breakfast Special Permit, 421 East Broadway

Dear Members of the City Council,

I am a neighbor of Maryam Salehi-Ala and Nikka Yamin and write in support of their petition to the Council for a special permit to operate a bed and breakfast at 421 East Broadway. Prior to the Yamin family's purchase of the property, the house was in bad condition, an eyesore, and was a concern to many in the neighborhood. The Yamin family has since done a great job renovating the house and fixing the issues with the property.

Maryam has spoken to me about her dream to operate a bed and breakfast at the property and asked that I write to the Council in support. After reviewing the plans and discussing the proposed business, I believe that a bed and breakfast is a reasonable use of the property and will not be disruptive or negatively impact the neighborhood. In addition to the usual overnight visitors, I understand and support the use of the property primarily for small-scale events, luncheons, and parties and occasional weddings and other larger events of up to 50-visitors.

I therefore request that the Council grant Maryam and Nikka's petition for a special permit with any reasonable conditions that the Council believes are necessary for the operation of a bed and breakfast on the property.

Sincerely,


(name)


(name)

407 E. Broadway
(address)

Dear Members of City Council,

I am a neighbor of 421 E. Broadway. After discussing the plans, I believe that a bed and breakfast is a beneficial use of the property and will positively impact the neighborhood. In addition to the usual overnight visitors, I understand and support the use of the property for small-scale gatherings.

I request that the Council grant the petition for a bed and breakfast with any reasonable conditions that the Council believes are necessary for the operation of a bed and breakfast on the property.

Thank you,

Nikra Yamin

M. SALEH IAH

423.E. Broadway

The following attachment includes new signatures from the following neighbors that are within 1,000 ft, collected from 7/22/26-7/26/26.

Pam Duffy 449 E. Broadway * **previously signed as an opposing neighbor. Is a supporter.**

Christine Roy 381 E. Broadway

Caitlyn Bradbury 31 Millvale Rd

Brian Leathe 43 Millvale Rd

Cheryl Roy 63/68 Millvale Rd * Listed as 63 on GIS but on house says 68.

Dear Members of City Council,

I am a neighbor of 421 E. Broadway. After discussing the plans, I believe that a bed and breakfast is a beneficial use of the property and will positively impact the neighborhood. In addition to the usual overnight visitors, I understand and support the use of the property for small-scale gatherings. X

I request that the Council grant the petition for a bed and breakfast with any reasonable conditions that the Council believes are necessary for the operation of a bed and breakfast on the property.

Thank you,

Pam Duff *Pg Duff*

449 E. Broadway

* My previous concern was centered on rezoning of the neighborhood in the future. My preference is for an approval to include language that would not allow future zoning changes based on this small home-based business. The occasional larger gathering would also liven up the neighborhood. Cheers!

7/26/20

Dear Members of City Council,

I am a neighbor of 421 E. Broadway. After discussing the plans, I believe that a bed and breakfast is a beneficial use of the property and will positively impact the neighborhood. In addition to the usual overnight visitors, I understand and support the use of the property for small-scale gatherings.

I request that the Council grant the petition for a bed and breakfast with any reasonable conditions that the Council believes are necessary for the operation of a bed and breakfast on the property.

Thank you,

Christine Roy 7-22-2026

301 East Broadway
Haverhill, MA 01838

Christine Roy

Dear Members of City Council,

I am a neighbor of 421 E. Broadway. After discussing the plans, I believe that a bed and breakfast is a beneficial use of the property and will positively impact the neighborhood. In addition to the usual overnight visitors, I understand and support the use of the property for small-scale gatherings.

I request that the Council grant the petition for a bed and breakfast with any reasonable conditions that the Council believes are necessary for the operation of a bed and breakfast on the property.

Thank you,



31 Millvale Rd, 7/22/26
Caitlyn Hill

Dear Members of City Council,

I am a neighbor of 421 E. Broadway. After discussing the plans, I believe that a bed and breakfast is a beneficial use of the property and will positively impact the neighborhood. In addition to the usual overnight visitors, I understand and support the use of the property for small-scale gatherings.

I request that the Council grant the petition for a bed and breakfast with any reasonable conditions that the Council believes are necessary for the operation of a bed and breakfast on the property.

Thank you,

BML

43 Millvale Rd

7/26/22

BML

Dear Members of City Council,

I am a neighbor of 421 E. Broadway. After discussing the plans, I believe that a bed and breakfast is a beneficial use of the property and will positively impact the neighborhood. In addition to the usual overnight visitors, I understand and support the use of the property for small-scale gatherings.

I request that the Council grant the petition for a bed and breakfast with any reasonable conditions that the Council believes are necessary for the operation of a bed and breakfast on the property.

Thank you,

Chen P. Roy
68 Millvale Rd
7-26-26

Lori Robertson

From: Andrea DeMonaco <andreademonaco6@gmail.com>
Sent: Saturday, July 25, 2026 1:11 PM
To: City Council
Subject: Miriams Cottage

Warning! External Email: Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Dear Council Members,

I am writing in support of the proposed business Miriam's Cottage.

I got to know Miriam some years ago and with each passing year my admiration for her has grown. Miriam is a kind, smart and industrious woman with many talents. Her dedication to her endeavors, whether it be cultivating an impressive vegetable and flower garden, teaching cooking classes or renovating an aging home is commendable, and the amount of thought she puts into it all ensures success.

I have been a Haverhill resident for the past 39 years and have enjoyed watching this city with a small town feel grow and prosper with shops, restaurants and family friendly events.

I visited Miriam's Cottage shortly before the city council meeting on June 30th and was amazed- yet not surprised- at the transformation of this treasure of a house that had been long neglected.

That feat alone is already a bonus to our city.

In this increasingly disconnected age we are living in, a tasteful gathering spot would be in my opinion a very welcome addition. This sentiment has been echoed by every person I have talked to about the prospective business.

I don't see these gatherings being visibly or audibly disruptive to the area, and you can be assured in Miriam's hands it will all be tasteful and refined.

I thank you in advance for considering my opinion, and urge you to give this business a chance- it would certainly be a feather in Haverhill's cap.

Sincerely,

Andrea DeMonaco
137 Old Groveland Road

7/24/26

Dear City Counselors,

I have written this letter in regard to Maryam Yamin's entrepreneurship. Over the last few years of getting to know Maryam it has been a blessing. I have gotten to know her very well throughout our classes and after school events such as birthday parties, luncheons, and study sessions. She has displayed she is capable of several skills to operate her business efficiently. Maryam has showcased a lot of skills in class which include her hospitality, her hosting skills and decoration skills. In class we had a course called BOE (Banquet operating events) where we practiced hospitality, hosting and decorating a room in theme. Maryam was hand selected by the head chef to not only decorate but was nominated as sous chef. As the sous chef, she was also in charge of hosting and coordinating to make sure the guests were comfortable and had everything they needed.

For all businesses, a demographic is targeted. The town is concerned over populating the area by increasing traffic but that would be a great opportunity for Haverhill. Haverhill gets to show the light of the city, the beautiful history it holds. Why take away from the city? Why not display the history? Why deny a calm peaceful event? The town is frowning upon elegance and tranquility being offered but would immediately accept a fast food chain that would truly destroy the environment. Fast food chains increase traffic significantly. Also, the food does not help our fellow residents replenish themselves. Fast food chains are only looking for profit, no concern for the state or residence. With Maryam she will offer historic views, replenish food, and tranquility. This is a business proposal being offered at the acceptance of city approval. Meanwhile the city allows fast food businesses to operate without consistently checking food quality, traffic violations, noise complaints or violence in areas nearby. The businesses that fill the nearby area are open till 2am which passes Haverhill noise timeframes. She is getting denied an opportunity before she has expressed herself. She is always going above and beyond to meet expectations. Maryam truly has the city and residence in consideration. She will be more than willing to work during Haverhill noise compliant timeframes. That applies for the city and the residents.

Best regards,
Amariliz Colon



Dear Council President Jordan and Haverhill City Councilors,

On behalf of the Greater Haverhill Chamber, we are pleased to express our strong support for the proposed Bed & Breakfast on 421 East Broadway Street.

As an organization dedicated to supporting local businesses, encouraging investment, and strengthening our community, we believe this project is an excellent example of responsible development that benefits both the neighborhood and the City of Haverhill.

We understand that many of you have had the opportunity to visit the Bed & Breakfast, and we hope you would agree that the transformation of this property has been remarkable. What was once a condemned and neglected house has been thoughtfully restored into a beautiful Bed & Breakfast that enhances the neighborhood's character. This investment has replaced a blighted property with something the neighborhood and community can be proud of, improving the streetscape and demonstrating how restoring historic homes can have a positive impact on Haverhill.

Equally important is the character and commitment of the business owners, Maryam and her son Arash. Throughout this process, they have demonstrated a genuine desire to work collaboratively with the City and surrounding neighbors. They have carefully considered the concerns raised by councilors, listened to feedback, and made meaningful changes to address those concerns. Their willingness to edit their plans reflects not only responsible business practices but also a sincere commitment to becoming valued members of the Haverhill business community.

This Bed & Breakfast also offers something unique that complements Haverhill's growing hospitality and tourism economy. In addition to welcoming overnight guests, the property provides an intimate and unique venue for bridal showers, baby showers, birthday celebrations, business meetings, and other small gatherings. These types of venues are in demand and add to the diversity of experiences available in our city, while supporting local restaurants, retailers, and service providers.

Additionally, the Bed & Breakfast is situated on the property in a private setting, naturally separated from the abutting residence by a mature tree line. The existing trees provide an effective natural buffer, helping to preserve privacy for the neighbors.

The Greater Haverhill Chamber supports projects like this that contribute to the continued growth and vitality of our local economy. They encourage tourism, support entrepreneurship, preserve beautiful properties, and create destinations that make Haverhill an even more attractive place to visit, invest, and call home.

Furthermore, the Chamber proudly supports business owners who invest in Haverhill with integrity, collaborate with the community, and work to create positive experiences for residents and visitors alike. We believe this project embodies those values, and we respectfully encourage the City Council to approve the proposed Bed & Breakfast.

Thank you for your thoughtful consideration and for your continued commitment to supporting responsible economic development in our community.

Sincerely,

Allison Heartquist
Chair
Greater Haverhill Chamber

Penelope Guerrero Perez
Vice Chair
Greater Haverhill Chamber

Lori Robertson

From: Philbrook, Bryan C <bphilbrook@necc.mass.edu>
Sent: Monday, July 27, 2026 7:15 AM
To: Lori Robertson
Subject: Re: Letter of Support for Maryam Yamin
Attachments: Maryam Yamin Letter of support.docx

Warning! External Email: Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links

Good morning,

I hope you're having a wonderful summer.

I was asked to resubmit my letter of support for Maryum Yamin for the upcoming City Council meeting. There have been no changes to my original letter, so I am resubmitting the same letter as part of this email.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Respectfully,

Bryan Philbrook
Program Coordinator, Culinary Arts
Northern Essex Community College

Get [Outlook for iOS](#)

From: Lori Robertson <lrobertson@haverhillma.gov>
Sent: Friday, 26 June 2026 08:10:05
To: Philbrook, Bryan C <bphilbrook@necc.mass.edu>
Subject: RE: Letter of Support for Maryam Yamin

ATTENTION: This email is from an external source. Do Not click on any links or open any attachments unless you recognize the sender and know the content is safe. To report a suspicious email, please use the new phishing alert button in outlook

Good morning!

Thank you for your email. I will it share it with the City Councilors and upload onto the online application.

Have a great day.

Best regards,

Lori

Lori A. Robertson
Administrative Assistant
Haverhill City Council
4 Summer Street- Room #204

Haverhill, MA 01830
978-374-2328 phone
978-374-2329-fax
lrobertson@haverhillma.gov
citycouncil@haverhillma.gov

From: Philbrook, Bryan C <bphilbrook@necc.mass.edu>

Sent: Friday, June 26, 2026 7:12 AM

To: Lori Robertson <lrobertson@haverhillma.gov>

Subject: Letter of Support for Maryam Yamin

Warning: External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Dear Members of the Haverhill City Council,

Please find my attached letter of support for Maryum Yamin.

Respectfully,

Bryan Philbrook
Program Coordinator, Culinary Arts
Northern Essex Community College

June 25, 2026

Lori A. Robertson

Administrative Assistant

Haverhill City Council

4 Summer Street, Room 204

Haverhill, MA 01830

Dear Members of the Haverhill City Council,

I am writing in support of Maryam Yamin, a graduate of the Culinary Arts Program at Northern Essex Community College, who is seeking approval for a proposed bed-and-breakfast venture in the City of Haverhill.

As Maryam's instructor and Program Coordinator, I had the opportunity to observe her academic performance, work ethic, professionalism, and commitment to her goals. Throughout her studies, she consistently demonstrated dedication, perseverance, and a genuine passion for hospitality and culinary arts.

Maryam approached her coursework with enthusiasm and professionalism, consistently demonstrating initiative, dependability, and a willingness to learn. She welcomed feedback, embraced challenges, and continually sought to improve her skills.

She possesses many of the qualities essential for success in the hospitality industry. Maryam is hardworking, organized, personable, and committed to providing positive experiences for others. She has a natural talent for hospitality and consistently demonstrates warmth, professionalism, and genuine care when interacting with guests, clients, and colleagues. She also worked exceptionally well with her peers, frequently offering support, sharing her knowledge, and serving as a positive role model within our program. Her collaborative spirit, leadership, and culinary training have prepared her well to pursue her entrepreneurial goals.

During her time in the program, Maryam also participated in catering and hospitality events serving members of the local community. Through these experiences, she demonstrated professionalism, excellent customer service, and the ability to perform effectively in fast-paced environments while representing both herself and the college in a positive manner.

I am proud of the progress Maryam has made and the initiative she has shown in pursuing opportunities that contribute to both her professional growth and the local community. Based on my experiences working with her as a student, I believe she has the character, determination, and skills necessary to be successful in her future endeavors.

As an educator, I believe it is important to support our graduates as they transition from the classroom into their professional careers. It is especially rewarding to see alumni invest their talents and energy back into the communities they serve. Should Maryam's venture move forward, it may also create opportunities for future collaboration through student internships, experiential learning, or employment opportunities for aspiring culinary and hospitality professionals.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Bryan Philbrook
Program Coordinator and Professor, Culinary Arts
Northern Essex Community College

Lori Robertson

From: daniel.whitney29@icloud.com
Sent: Monday, July 27, 2026 10:23 AM
To: City Council
Subject: Miriam Salehi's Bed and Breakfast

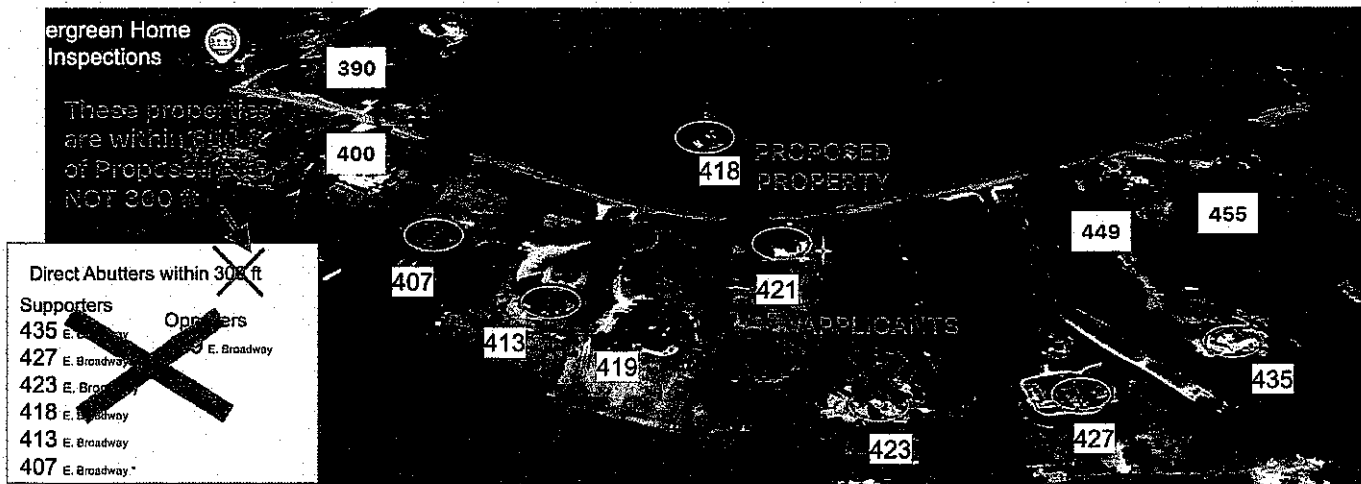
Warning! External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Good Day,

I am writing the city council as a 29 year resident of Haverhill. I would very much love to see this historic bed and breakfast that Ms. Salehi has proposed become a reality. This would be a relaxing, elevated environment with activities like afternoon tea, and adult crafts. I think it is a wonderful chance to add some sophistication for the people that appreciate such, as well as preserving and showcasing our local history. I ask you to consider my thoughts and enthusiasm for this project as a lifetime resident of the city. Please forward this to all other councilors.

Best Regards,
Daniel J. Whitney
Sent from my iPhone

Rebuttal to "Miriam's Cottage Direct Abutters Map"



Among property owners and their families within 650 ft:

SUPPORTERS	OPPOSERS
435 E. Broadway (1) - 5 properties	455 E. Broadway (2) - 5 properties
427 E. Broadway (1) - 6 people	449 E. Broadway (2) - 13 people
418 E. Broadway (1)	419 E. Broadway (4)
413 E. Broadway (1)	400 E. Broadway (3)
407 E. Broadway (2)	390 E. Broadway (2)

Support or Oppose	Address	Name of Signee(s)	Lot Size (Acres)	Approx. Lot Frontage (Ft)	NOTES
Support	435 E. Broadway	Alexander Burke	4.85	129	
Support	427 E. Broadway	Philip Rice	4.45	149	
Support	423 E. Broadway	Maryam Salehi Ala Nikke Yamin	3.15	139	Applicants
Support	421 E. Broadway	Address of Permit	2.45	158	Proposed property
Support	418 E. Broadway	Scott W. Sol	21.3	427	
Support	413 E. Broadway	Denise Chesky	5.13	147	
Support	407 E. Broadway	Acadia Leathe Dany Boulanger	3.23	155	
Oppose	419 E. Broadway	Judith Biewener Tim Sturgeon Maxine Sturgeon Jordan Wolff	4.85 2.71	152	
Oppose	455 E. Broadway	Kathy McCormick Fernand Tomaz			Excluded from applicant's map
Oppose	449 E. Broadway	Pam Duffy Ken Duffy			Excluded from applicant's map
Oppose	400 E. Broadway	Lisa Onyon John McCutcheon Caitlin McCutcheon			Excluded from applicant's map
Oppose	390 E. Broadway	Pam White John White			Excluded from applicant's map

Neighbors within 1,000 feet of proposed B&B

Neighbors who signed petition to oppose:

- 384 East Broadway (2)
- 390 East Broadway (2)
- 400 East Broadway (3)
- 419 East Broadway (direct abutters) (4)
- 449 East Broadway (2)
- 455 East Broadway (2)
- 459 East Broadway (6)
- 460 East Broadway (2)

8 properties/23 people

468

E Broadway

460

459

455

435

449

E Broadway

427

423 Applicant

**421
Proposed Bed
& Breakfast**

418

419

Direct abutters

413

407

400

390

384

Neighbors who wrote signed letters of support:

- 407 (2)
- 418 (1)
- 413 (1)
- 427 (1)
- 435 (1)

5 properties/6 people

New:

Distance from Property of people who wrote letters in support

(beyond those noted in the Applicant's Direct Abutters Map document)

Name	Address	Miles from 421 E Broadway
Kara Sotirakopoulos	483 East Broadway	0.3
Andrew Fanaras	551 East Broadway	0.9
Don Cox	595 East Broadway	1.3
Guylaine Beaulieu	639 East Broadway	1.3
Pamela Daggett	650 East Broadway	1.4
Tina Maglio	5 Seven Sisters Rd.	1.4
Karina Larson	656 E. Broadway	1.4
Dale Leon & Terri Hennessey	21 Race St	2.2
Deb Sacco	Linwood St	2.2
Doreen Hillard	32 Isabel St.	3.1
Laura Johnson	35 Arlington St	3.8
Kelly Scott	West Newbury	4.3
Jessica Bush	16 Tyler Park	5.1
Alison Colby-Campbell	112 Farrwood Dr.	7.2
Cynthia McKallagat	93 Beechwood Dr.	8.4
Amaritz Colon	<i>No address given – <u>Character reference</u></i>	
Graham Hill-Whilton	<i>Boston – <u>Business partner</u></i>	
Sharon Donovan	<i>No address given – <u>Wedding guest</u></i>	
Bryan Philbrook	<i>No address given – <u>Character reference</u></i>	
Lisa Marie Wilson	<i>No address given</i>	
Janice McHugh	<i>No address given</i>	
Madeleine Maguire	<i>No address given</i>	

Lori Robertson

From: Yan Zhou <yzhouchen001@gmail.com>
Sent: Monday, July 27, 2026 11:56 AM
To: City Council
Subject: Mariam's Cottage

Warning: External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Dear Councillors,

As a Haverhill resident, I am writing in support of the bed and breakfast project. I believe bed and breakfasts offer an enjoyable combination of vacation and experiences in an intimate setting provided by the host, such as the proposed afternoon tea. A high tea experience would be a classy residential gathering place for Haverhill, while a bed and breakfast would provide visitors a way to appreciate our community.

When watching the recording of the hearing, I was disappointed to see councillors give greater weight to concerns from a few neighbors rather than future benefits of this small business to Haverhill. I understand neighbors should have an opportunity to voice their concerns, however, I hope realistic concerns are being discerned from some exaggerated concerns: the homes on this part of East Broadway are spaced far apart, yet several comments made it sound as though a fraternity or concert venue was proposed rather than a small bed and breakfast.

This bed and breakfast could be a place of gathering and celebration for our quaint community, but unfortunately I have heard from multiple people that the strong attention to the overpowering neighbors' concerns has made it difficult for people to openly support this project without reprimand from the opposing community. Thus, please consider my voice as a strong advocate in support of opening the bed and breakfast due to the high class, sense of community, and unique gathering opportunity this bed and breakfast brings.

Sincerely,
Yan Zhou

GRAETERLAW LLC
P.O. Box 3229
Beverly, MA 01915
(617) 529-3271
philip@graeterlaw.com

July 27, 2026

By Email Only to citycouncil@haverhillma.gov

Timothy J. Jordan, President
Haverhill City Council
4 Summer Street
Haverhill, MA 01830

Re: CCSP-26-3 – Special Permit Application, 421 East Broadway

Dear President Jordan and Members of the Council:

I write on behalf of Timothy Sturgeon and Judith Biewener of 419 East Broadway, direct abutters to the property at 421 East Broadway (“Property”), on which the applicant, Maryam Salehi-Ala-Yamin (“Applicant”) seeks to operate a bed-and-breakfast establishment. My clients have written to the Council and appeared in person at the prior hearings on the application. Following the June 30th hearing, they proposed conditions that would be acceptable to Applicant’s counsel in writing on July 22nd. Applicant’s counsel noted by email this morning that their most recently revised proposed conditions, submitted on July 24th, is the Applicant’s response. My clients continue to oppose the application, even in its most recently revised form, for the following reasons.

1. Owner Occupancy

As the Council is aware, the Haverhill Zoning Ordinance (“Ordinance”) allows a “bed-and-breakfast establishment” (“B&B”) in a Residential Rural Density (“RR”) district with a special permit. A B&B is defined as “[a]n owner-occupied dwelling with not more than six rooms available for overnight rental, with or without breakfast. (Ordinance, § 11.1). Despite the Applicant’s efforts to expand the meaning of “owner-occupied,” it is clear from the Ordinance taken as a whole that actual residence by the property owner or long-term lessee is both fundamental to the nature of a B&B and required for the use to be permitted in a residential district.

The Ordinance prohibits lodging, restaurant, and commercial education and event venue uses in residential districts. The narrow exception for B&Bs with a special permit is rooted in the requirement that the owner reside at the premises. Owner occupancy is not an inconvenience to be dispensed with, but part of the nature of a B&B, which is seen as an extension of the

residential use precisely because the home is, in fact, a residence. Limiting the number of rooms that can be rented and limiting meal service specifically to breakfast is designed to ensure a small-scale operation confined to the physical space of a single-family home otherwise allowed in the district, such that it would be no more out of place in the neighborhood than the comings and goings of a large family.

In addition, a B&B must be operated in a “dwelling,” which is defined as:

A privately or publicly owned permanent structure which is occupied in whole or part as the home residence or sleeping place of one or more persons. The terms “one-family, two-family or multifamily dwelling” shall not include a hotel, lodging house, hospital, membership club, trailer or dormitory.

(Ordinance, § 11.1.) A building that is not anyone’s “home residence or sleeping place” is not a “dwelling” under the Ordinance and, thus, cannot be used as a B&B.

Owner occupancy is also required to be consistent with the Ordinance’s prohibition on short-term rentals of homes in residential districts by exclusion from the permitted uses for such property. (Ordinance, §§ 3.1.1 and Appendix A.) Short-term rental of individual rooms or accessory dwelling units in residential districts is specifically prohibited. (Ordinance, Appendix A at A (6) (lodging, boarding or rooming houses), I (15) (hotels and motels), §11.1 (ADUs). These restrictions exist because “short-term rental use of a one family home is inconsistent with the zoning purpose of the single-residence zoning district in which it is situated, i.e., to preserve the residential character of the neighborhood.” Styller v. Zoning Bd. of Lynnfield, 487 Mass. 588, 599 (2021).

Finally, the Ordinance’s special permit requirement recognizes that a B&B poses the threat of “substantial detriment to the neighborhood” and requires the Council to consider its effect on the “[n]eighborhood character and social structures” among other factors. (Ordinance, § 10.4.2.) The fact that the Ordinance permits B&Bs as of right in the Commercial Neighborhood (CN) and Commercial Highway (CH) districts in the downtown area illustrates that a B&B poses no threat to the character of those zoning districts, as it does in the RR district. A total of 23 neighbors at eight homes within 1,000 feet of the Property have expressed their opinion that allowing the permit will constitute a substantial detriment to the neighborhood. For reference, see Rebuttal to Miriam’s Cottage Direct Abutters Map, submitted on July 27th.

My clients do not suggest that the Applicant be required to live in the Property full time or as her sole residence, only that the owner occupancy requirement contemplates the owner of a B&B residing on the property as a homeowner would when there are overnight guests. Anything other than requiring the owner to have a separate bedroom and bathroom would be treating the role more like a night watchman than homeowner.

A B&B without overnight guests is just a house and the Applicant can choose whether to stay there or not like any other homeowner. Conversely, a bed and breakfast without a resident

owner is a hotel. Waiving the owner occupancy requirement would be inconsistent with the language, purpose and intent of the Ordinance and set an unfortunate precedent.

2. Events and Classes

The Applicant seeks to engage in business activities in a residential district that are expressly prohibited by the Ordinance under the cover of being natural extensions of the B&B use. The definition of “bed-and-breakfast establishment” in the Ordinance is less than comprehensive but contains two specific guardrails to limit the size and scope of the business portion of an operation intended to be residential in character: (1) no more than six rooms can be available for overnight rental, thus limiting the number of potential guests to approximately 12; and (2) optional meal service for those overnight guests is limited to breakfast.¹ Whether or not B&Bs in other towns and cities may be permitted to engage in other business uses, in Haverhill the Ordinance expressly permits only the rental of rooms to overnight guests and breakfast service and, by implication, accessory residential uses allowed in the district, none of which include the business of hosting events.

Pursuant to the proposed conditions dated July 24, 2026, the Applicant seeks to expand the B&B use to include events for up to 30 people, including baby and wedding showers, cooking and flower arrangement classes, teas, and similar gatherings. The proposed conditions describe the limit as “a maximum of thirty (30) guests” and presumably does not include event staff, such as caterers, servers, and bartenders, in that limit.

No business is permitted to sell event services or event space or otherwise host a party or event, including entertainment, parking, and related services, in a residential district. Similarly, a business conducting art-related classes cannot operate in a residential district. The only exception for such classes in an RR district is for those conducted as a Home Occupation, which limits the number of students to five at any one time and must be “conducted solely within a dwelling [i.e., indoors] and solely by the person(s) occupying the dwelling as a primary residence.” (Ordinance, §§ 3.3.1 & 3.3.2.) Unless the Applicant intends to live on the Property as her primary residence and adhere to the class size and location limits, classes for hire are outside the scope of residential use.

The Ordinance does not include a specific “event facility” use and the closest approximation, “recreational facility,” includes a variety of indoor uses not relevant here. Additionally, the Ordinance does not contemplate a privately-owned outdoor recreational business use beyond “amusement facility” or “amusement park” (Appendix A at G(3)), which are plainly not applicable to the Property. Nonetheless, the intent of the Ordinance to prohibit the Applicant’s proposed business uses is clear in its prohibition of the following, with or without a special permit:

¹ Contrary to the Applicant’s claim that, “it would make little sense for a bed & breakfast to be limited to providing breakfast only, to the exclusion of other meals or dining experiences” (Letter to Thomas Bridgewater dated Dec. 12, 2025, p. 3), the Ordinance itself limits a B&B to breakfast for overnight guests. Permitting a B&B owner to serve meals other than breakfast to overnight guests as a business would be granting a backdoor permit to operate a restaurant, a use neither special permit granting authority in Haverhill can allow in a residential district.

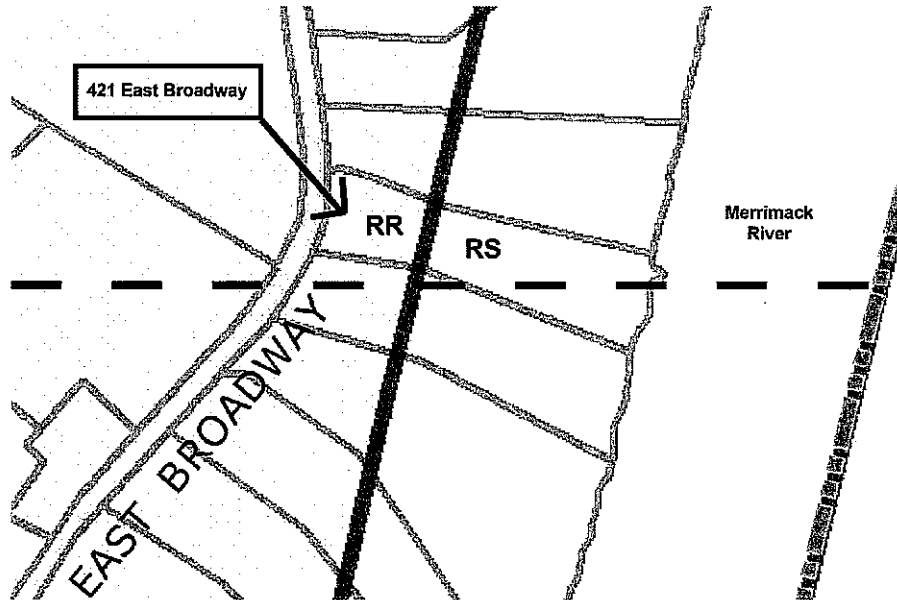
<u>Use</u>	<u>Table of Uses Section</u>
Recreational facility (indoor and operated for profit or nonprofit, including such items as stadium, race track, sports pavilion, etc.), unless otherwise specified.	D(8)
Catering services	I(3)
Restaurant, coffee shop, diner, luncheonette, and sandwich shop, without drive-through	G(1)
Cocktail lounge or bar, with live entertainment and/or dancing	G(5)
General retail and business, business and/or consumer service establishments, unless otherwise specified (See auto oriented and/or bulk storage activities, and entertainment, eating and/or drinking establishments)	F(1)
Professional and/or business schools for profit (includes dance, music, art, other professional and/or business schools)	I(19)
Commercial parking lot or structures	I(4)
Mixed use	I(20)

Allowing the Property to be used for the business of hosting events and classes where those business activities are not expressly permitted under the B&B use, are not residential in character, and are otherwise prohibited in the district would be contrary to Section 3.1.1, providing that “[a]ny use not listed shall be construed to be prohibited.”

Finally, because the principal use of a B&B must be residential in character and the proposed event facility use and educational use are commercial in nature, none of the proposed event and class business activities can be considered an accessory use, i.e., “a use incidental and subordinate to the principal use of a structure or lot or a use not the principal use which is located on the same lot as the principal structure.” None are among the accessory uses allowed in residential districts set forth in Section K of the Table of Uses (Ordinance, Appendix A) and the Council should decline the invitation to expand the scope of residential accessory uses to include the non-lodging related lines of business the Applicant wants to conduct on the Property.

3. Portion of Property in RS District

Should the Council grant the Applicant a special permit to operate a B&B within the constraints outlined above, any allowed use by the Applicant or overnight guests should be specifically limited to the portion of the Property in the RR zoning district. Approximately two-thirds of the Property lies in the RS zoning district, in which bed-and-breakfast establishments are not permitted with or without a special permit. (Ordinance, Appendix A at A(9).) This excerpt from the 2023 Zoning and Index Map is annotated to identify the Property and the river and label the zoning district on either side of the boundary line between them:



The Dimensional and Density Summary on the Applicant's engineering plans, including the parking plan, dated January 30, 2026 (uploaded March 23, 2026), and updated plan showing proposed landscaping and parking, dated April 6, 2026 (uploaded April 13 and Jul 7, 2026) identify the Property as lying in the RS zoning district, perhaps because the majority of the lot appears to be in that district, although the district boundary line is not shown on any plans on file with the Application:

DIMENSIONAL AND DENSITY SUMMARY			
ZONE DISTRICT: RS EXISTING USE: SINGLE FAMILY RESIDENTIAL PROPOSED USE: BED & BREAKFAST			
ITEM	REQUIRED	EXISTING	PROPOSED
MIN. LOT AREA	2 ACRES	106,864±S.F. 2.4532± ACRES	106,864±S.F. 2.4532± ACRES
MIN. LOT AREA/DU	NA	NA	NA
MIN. LOT FRONTAGE	200'	150'	150'
MIN. LOT DEPTH	150'	655'±	655'±
MINIMUM LOT SETBACKS:			
FRONT	40'	21.26'/25.5'	21.26'/25.5'
SIDE	25'	36.99'/61.45'	36.99'/61.45'
REAR	25'	555'±	555'±
MAXIMUM HEIGHT	35'	<35'	<35'
MAXIMUM STORIES	2.5 STORIES	2 STORIES	2 STORIES
MAX. BLDG. COVERAGE	15%	1.85%	1.85%
MAX. FLOOR AREA (FAR)	NONE	—	—
MIN. OPEN SPACE	70%	96.59%	96.59%
PARKING REQUIRED FOR BED & BREAKFAST (CODE L) 1 SPACE FOR RESIDENCE AND 1 SPACE/ROOM FOR RESTAURANT (CODE Y) 1 SPACE/3 SEATS	BED & BREAKFAST RESIDENCE: 1 SPACE 4 ROOMS: 4 SPACES TOTAL 5 SPACES FUNCTION/RESTAURANT 35 SEATS/1 SP/3 SEATS TOTAL 12 SPACES	2 IN GARAGE 2 BEHIND GARAGE 1 BKT. CONC. DRIVE 5 SPACES TOTAL	2 IN GARAGE 2 BEHIND GARAGE 7 NEW 1 BKT. CONC. DRIVE 12 TOTAL SPACES (31 SPACES WITH OVERFLOW)

To resolve any conflict between districts in this situation, the Ordinance provides that, "[w]here a district boundary line divides a lot of record at the time such line is adopted, the regulations for the less restricted portion of such lot shall extend not more than 30 feet into the

more restricted portion by special permit from the City Council.” (§2.3.) In the absence of an application for a special permit to extend the proposed use any distance beyond the RR district boundary, no use associated with a B&B should be permitted to extend outside the RR portion of the Property.

My clients are the only relevant direct abutters to the Property because the Applicant lives in the house on the other side of it. They stand to be the most directly and adversely impacted by the project, both by being next door and by the layout of respective lots. The proposed B&B sits on the upper portion of the Property close to the road. My client’s house, like the Applicant’s house on the other side, sits several hundred feet from the road on the lower portion of their lot. As such, the back yard and potential event space of the proposed B&B is directly adjacent to my clients’ front yard and house. Whatever business activities are permitted on the Property will be at their front door, a fact they hope the Council will carefully consider when weighing the merits of the application.

For the reasons set forth above and outlined in my clients’ previous submissions to the Council, they respectfully request that the application be denied.

Very truly yours,

/s/ Philip H. Graeter

Philip H. Graeter

cc: Kaitlin M. Wright Esposito, City Clerk (by email only)
Lori A. Robertson, Administrative Assistant (by email only)
Timothy Sturgeon and Judith Biewener

Lori Robertson

From: Lisa Mead <lisa@mtclawyers.com>
Sent: Monday, July 27, 2026 1:13 PM
To: Lori Robertson
Cc: Ralph T. Basiliere; Tim Jordan; Tim Jordan
Subject: Re: City Council Meeting July 28, 2026 agenda item 421 East Broadway

Warning! External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Councilors Basiliere and Jordan;

I have reviewed the below information as well as the zoning ordinance, only with regard to whether the proposal meets the requirements of a bed and breakfast. The abutter below is correct, in order for the proposal to classify as a bed and breakfast the owner must reside in the home. The owner may not reside in an adjacent property, but must literally occupy the home where the rooms are being let. Should the applicant wish to vary from the terms of the Ordinance, the Council may not waive the owner occupancy requirements. Rather, the applicant would need to seek a variance from the Zoning Board of Appeals. As noted below, the use of a Hotel is not allowed in the RR district.

Finally, as you are both aware, the Council may condition a special permit, should there be any concern about the occupancy of the building. Of course, the Council should not need to do that given the definition of the use and the requirement that the owner occupy/live in the home that is to be used as a bed and breakfast.

Please let me know if you have further questions.

Note, I removed the general email address of the Council so as to avoid a violation of the open meeting law. This email however, may be provided as part of the Council packets or at the meeting.

Lisa

Lisa L. Mead
[she/her/hers]



Mead, Talerman & Costa LLC
30 Green St
Newburyport MA 01950
978 463 7700 ext 101
978 463 7747 (fax)

The information contained herein is confidential and may be protected by the attorney-client and/or other applicable privilege(s). It is intended only for the named recipient(s). If you are neither an intended recipient nor a person responsible for delivery to a recipient, you are hereby notified that any unauthorized use, dissemination, distribution or reproduction of the contents hereof is strictly prohibited and may be unlawful. If you have received the above transmittal in error, please delete the message and any attachment(s) hereto from

your e-mail system and notify us immediately. *Please consider the environment before printing this email.*

♻️ Think before you print.



From: City Council <CityCouncil@haverhillma.gov>

Sent: Monday, July 27, 2026 9:23 AM

To: Lisa Mead <lisa@mtclawyers.com>

Cc: Ralph T. Basiliere <RBasiliere@haverhillma.gov>; Tim Jordan <tjjordan94@gmail.com>; Tim Jordan <tjordan@haverhillma.gov>

Subject: FW: City Council Meeting July 28, 2026 agenda item 421 East Broadway

Good morning, Lisa!

Councilor Basiliere asked me to share the email below from Lisa Onyon regarding the Bed and Breakfast request at 421 East Broadway. He would like your assessment on her communication below. The council is meeting on this tomorrow night.

Thank you,

Lori

Lori A. Robertson

Administrative Assistant

Haverhill City Council

4 Summer Street- Room #204

Haverhill, MA 01830

978-374-2328 phone

978-374-2329-fax

lrobertson@haverhillma.gov

citycouncil@haverhillma.gov

From: Ralph T. Basiliere <RBasiliere@haverhillma.gov>

Sent: Monday, July 27, 2026 9:19 AM

To: City Council <CityCouncil@haverhillma.gov>

Subject: Re: City Council Meeting July 28, 2026 agenda item 421 East Broadway

I'd like to know the city solicitor's assessment of the opinions contained in this communication.

Ralph T. Basiliere

City Councilor Ward 1

978 891 2281

[Get Outlook for Android](#)

From: Lisa Onyon <lisaonyon@gmail.com>

Sent: Monday, 27 July 2026 09:10:50

To: Tim Jordan <tjordan@haverhillma.gov>; John Michitson <JMichitson@haverhillma.gov>; Colin LePage <clepage@haverhillma.gov>; Thomas J. Sullivan <tsullivan@haverhillma.gov>; Ralph T. Basiliere <RBasiliere@haverhillma.gov>; Dan Diodati <DDiodati@HaverhillMa.gov>; Devan Ferreira <DFerreira@haverhillma.gov>; Melissa Lewandowski <mlewandowski@haverhillma.gov>; Shaun Toohey <stoohey@haverhillma.gov>; Michael McGonagle <mmcgonagle@HaverhillMa.gov>; Catherine Rogers <crogers@haverhillma.gov>

Subject: City Council Meeting July 28, 2026 agenda item 421 East Broadway

Warning! External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

400 East Broadway
Haverhill, MA 01830
July 26, 2026

Haverhill City Council
Re: Application for Special Permit 421 East Broadway

Dear Councilors,

We are writing to you regarding the application for a special permit to grant operation of a Bed-and-Breakfast at 421 East Broadway.

For point of reference, as the housing numbers are not sequential on our street, there is a house that is diagonally opposite the applicant, which is currently rented. We live in the house that abuts that rented house.

Under both Massachusetts law and City of Haverhill regulations, it is clearly defined that a specific and key element of the very definition of a Bed and Breakfast is that it be "owner-occupied". Without this element, the establishment VERY CLEARLY falls under a separate definition of "hotel".

A. Commonwealth of Massachusetts Definitions

<https://malegislature.gov/Laws/GeneralLaws/PartI/TitleIX/Chapter64g/Section1>

The screenshot shows the official website of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts, specifically the section for General Laws. The page is titled "SECTION 1" and "Section 1: Definitions". It includes a navigation menu with links to "Bills & Laws", "Budget", "Legislators", "Clerks", "Hearings & Events", "Committees & Commissions", and "State House". The main content area displays the text of Section 1, which defines various terms used in Chapter 64G. The definitions include "Bed and breakfast establishment", "Bed and breakfast home", "Commissioner", "Hosting platform", and "Hotel". The page also features a search bar and a "Print Page" button.

THE 194TH GENERAL COURT OF THE
COMMONWEALTH OF MASSACHUSETTS

July 26, 2026

General Laws - Part I - Title IX - Chapter 64G -

SECTION 1

GENERAL LAWS

Chapter Section

Part I

Title I

Title II

Title III

Title IV

Title V

Title VI

Title VII

Title VIII

Title IX

Chapter 64G

Chapter 64A

Chapter 64

Section 1: Definitions

Text of section effective as provided by 2018, 237, Sec. 15A as added by 2019, 2, Sec. 371

Section 1. As used in this chapter, the following words shall have the following meanings unless the context clearly requires otherwise:

"Bed and breakfast establishment", a private owner-occupied house where not less than 4 rooms are let, a breakfast is included in the rent and all accommodations are reserved in advance

"Bed and breakfast home", a private owner-occupied house where not more than 3 rooms are let, a breakfast is included in the rent and all accommodations are reserved in advance

"Commissioner", the commissioner of revenue.

"Hosting platform", a service through a digital platform, third-party website, software, online-enabled application, mobile phone application or some other, similar electronic process that allows (i) an operator to advertise, list or offer the use of an accommodation subject to the excise under this chapter in exchange for rent; (ii) an operator to collect the payment of rent on an accommodation, and (iii) a person to arrange, book, reserve or rent an accommodation.

"Hotel", a building used for the feeding and lodging of guests licensed or required to be licensed under section 6 of chapter 140.

"Bed and breakfast establishment", a **private owner-occupied house** where not less than 4 rooms are let, a breakfast is included in the rent and all accommodations are reserved in advance.

"Bed and breakfast home", a **private owner-occupied house** where not more than 3 rooms are let, a breakfast is included in the rent and all accommodations are reserved in advance.

"Hotel", a building used for the feeding and lodging of guests licensed or required to be licensed under section 6 of chapter 140.

B. City of Haverhill Definitions

Section 11.1 Definitions of Chapter 255 of the Haverhill Zoning Code

<https://ecode360.com/36953238>

City of Haverhill, MA > Code 2025-05-08 > The Code > Part II General Legislation > Chapter 255 Zoning > SECTION 11.1 DEFINITIONS

definition of "collar")

BED-AND-BREAKFAST ESTABLISHMENT
An owner-occupied dwelling with not more than six rooms available for overnight rental, with or without breakfast.

BOARD
The Zoning Board of Appeals of the City of Haverhill.

BED-AND-BREAKFAST ESTABLISHMENT

An owner-occupied dwelling with not more than six rooms available for overnight rental, with or without breakfast.

City of Haverhill, MA > Code 2025-05-08 > The Code > Part II General Legislation > Chapter 255 Zoning > SECTION 11.1 DEFINITIONS

HOTEL
A building or any part of a building containing primarily rooming units without individual cooking facilities for transient occupancy and having a common entrance or entrances, including an inn, motel, motor inn and tourist court, but not including a lodging house. A "hotel" may include units containing individual cooking facilities, provided that the number of such units does not exceed 10% of the total number of units.

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While the applicant wants to call this facility a Bed & Breakfast (whether it be an "establishment" or a "home") it does not meet the very required definition by nature of not being owner-occupied. This is further supported by the fact that it DOES meet the definition of a hotel. Where an establishment does not meet one definition but clearly meets another, you cannot grant a "waiver" to move it from one definition to the other. This is most especially true where there are different guidelines and permissions for the two different types of establishments.

With all due respect, the City Council is overstepping its authority to grant a special permit to this applicant. This is not a Bed & Breakfast. By definition it is a hotel. And the granting of permission for a hotel within the RR zone is not within the authority of the City Council.

Under Attachment 1 Table 1 of City of Haverhill's Chapter 255 Zoning Regulations the City Council does not have jurisdiction to grant a hotel in a RR zone

<https://ecode360.com/attachment/332420/HA0760-255a%20Table%201%20Table%20of%20Use%20and%20Parking%20Regs.pdf>

ZONING

	RS	RR	RL	RM	RH	RU	CN	CU	CG	CC	CM	OP	BG	BP	PC
1. MISCELLANEOUS COMMERCIAL USES															
1. Blueprinting, photostating, or custom printing	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	Y	Y	Y	N	Y	Y	Y	E
2. Business machine and equipment repair service	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	Y	Y	N	N	Y	Y	E
3. Caring service	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	BA	BA	BA	N	N	Y	Y	F
4. Commercial parking lot or structures	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	Y	Y	N	Y	Y	N	None
5. Contractors	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	None
6. Delivery service and/or parcel post	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	Y	Y	N	Y	Y	Y	E
7. Dry-cleaning and/or linen supply processing plant	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	BA	BA	N	N	N	Y	Y	D
8. Dry-cleaning pickup station	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	Y	Y	Y	N	Y	Y	Y	C
9. Dry-cleaning pickup station and processing facility not to exceed 4,000 square feet gross floor area	N	N	N	N	N	N	BA	BA	BA	BA	N	BA	BA	BA	C
10. Fuel distributor	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	Y	N	N	N	Y	N	E
11. Fuel storage tanks (aboveground) for fuel distribution	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	BA	BA	N	N	N	BA	N	E
12. Funeral home or establishment	N	N	N	N	BA	BA	N	Y	Y	Y	N	N	N	N	D
13. Home-improvement contractor, cabinet maker, kitchen or bathroom equipment sales, electrical or plumbing shop (with no outdoor storage)	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	Y	Y	N	N	Y	Y	E
14. Home-improvement contractor, cabinet maker, kitchen or bathroom equipment sales, electrical or plumbing shop (with outdoor storage)	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	BA	BA	N	N	N	Y	N	E
15. Hotel or motel	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	CC	CC	CC	N	CC	CC	CC	J
16. Janitorial service firm	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	Y	Y	N	N	Y	N	F
17. Landscaping service company	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	Y	N	N	N	N	N	E
18. Landscaping/snow plowing	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	None
19. Professional and/or business schools for profit (includes dance, music, art, other professional and/or business schools)	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	Y	Y	N	N	Y	N	I
20. Trade school for profit	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	Y	N	Y	Y	Y	I
21. Animal day clinic	N	N	N	N	N	N	N	BA	N	N	N	N	N	N	D

This application should be denied as it does not meet the very definition of a Bed & Breakfast and the City Council does not have jurisdiction to grant a permit for a Hotel in RR zone.

Further, we believe the applicant has presented to you some revised "conditions" which still include having functions of up to 30 people. We believe this is further evidence of this facility being a "hotel" and not a "B&B".

It is not merely nominal to differentiate between a B&B and hotel. There are enhanced regulations on hotels regarding requiring a commercial kitchen, food establishment permits, fire codes and requirements such as second staircases and sprinklers, ADA access, licensing, etc.. The differences are great and should not be taken lightly.

Chapter 355 does not grant the City Council authority to give a special permit to a hotel masquerading as a B&B. You should deny this permit on the grounds that the establishment does not meet the definition.

However, if despite all of this, should you still consider granting such a special permit we would like to mention some additional concerns. Some of which Lisa was able to speak to briefly at the last meeting at which this application was discussed, but we would like to expand on what was said. Some of which there was not enough time allowed to be able to mention.

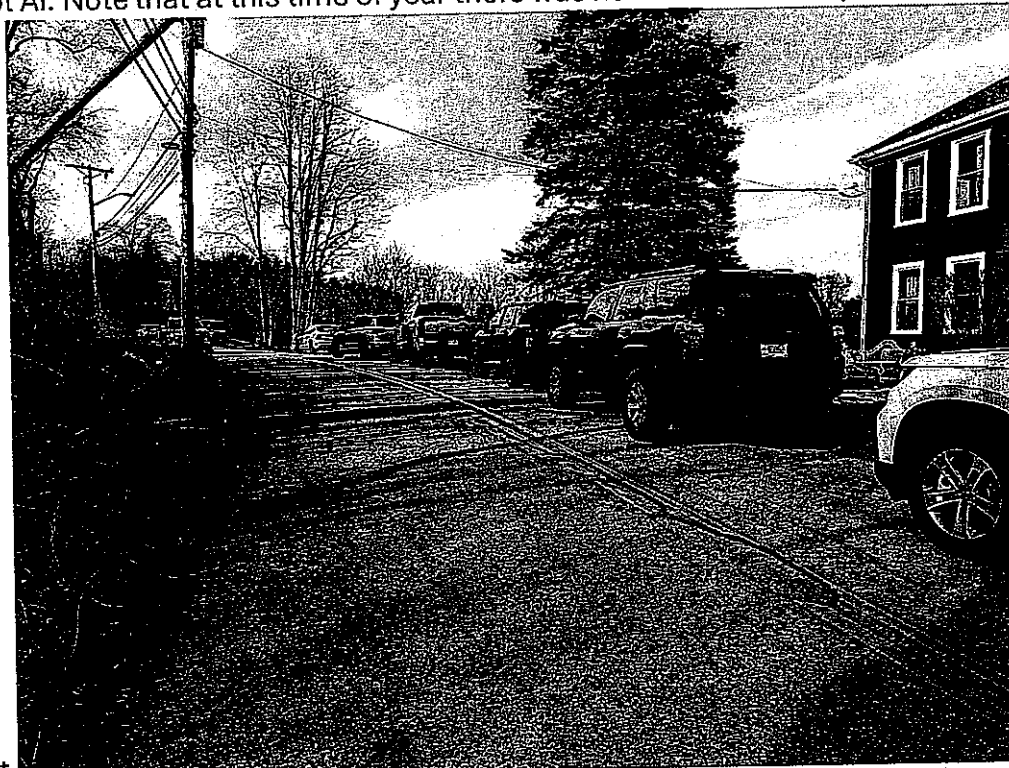
A. Dangerous curve and parking

It has been mentioned that this curve is dangerous. But we think it may be hard for you to imagine what it is like when cars are actually parked on it. We don't have to imagine. We have experienced it. Most recently earlier this year, our daughter was trying to drive home and after narrowly missing being hit told us about this crazy situation, that we documented with these photos. This is not AI. This is how people actually parked their cars. Lisa called the police to report this. We don't wish to have a situation like this

again. (While this was not an event at 421 East Broadway, it shows the property in question and the danger when cars park near it).

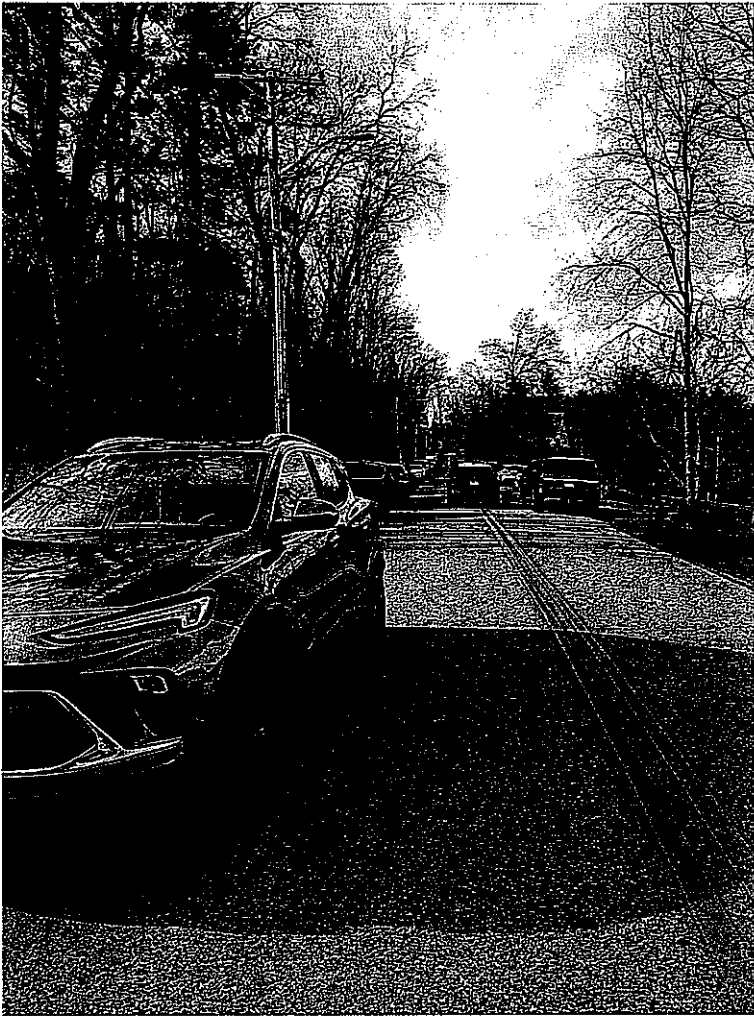
Left to their own devices, this is how people WILL park. If the applicant is allowed to have any kind of function, they should be required to have a parking attendant on the street to direct traffic to the overflow area and prevent any further situations such as this. The attendant should be on duty for the duration of any event.

These pictures are not AI. Note that at this time of year there was not the additional plant growth that



further restricts sight.





B. Special Conservation Zone

Both this property, and the abutting property where the applicant indicates will have overflow parking, contain a portion of land that are in the special conservation zones. Have these been properly reviewed by the Conservation Dept. with regard specifically to overflow parking and clear guidelines where parking may and may not be permissible been determined?

C. Applicant's Revised Conditions

While it is some progress that the applicant has presented "revised conditions", it does appear they have chosen their words carefully.

("1) Small gatherings may take place primarily within the structure and/or on the porch but shall be limited to a maximum of thirty (30) guests."

The word "primarily" should be struck and replaced with "only".

Further, this number of guests exceeds what we believe was suggested by some Council members at the previous meeting. We think it would be appropriate to get a review by the fire chief as to what a safe capacity is for an event in the interior only of the structure.

"(2) No tents requiring a permit from the city shall be erected. "

There should be no need for tents, whether Haverhill regulations have anticipated such an event and spelled them out or not, if all the events will be inside the structure or on the porch. Simply "No tents shall be erected" is the more appropriate condition.

"(3) Gatherings shall not include bands or DJs, and gatherings must comply with the City's noise ordinance.

(4) Gatherings shall be limited to the hours of 9:00 A.M. to 9:00 P.M, except for use of the house, porch, and grounds by overnight guests."

It should not be only "gatherings" that must comply with the City's noise ordinance. Guests should not be allowed on the porch or grounds after 9pm and making noise in excess of city, state, and environmental regulations at any time.

D. No Hardship

Our sense from applicant's presentation has been an implication of "hardship" . Let us be clear. The applicants are real estate owners of at least 3 properties that are on record in the City's records. They are not a struggling property owner trying to figure out how to stay afloat. No hardship consideration should be given at all to this situation.

E. Testimony to character of talent of applicant

At the previous Council meeting when this application was presented, a 3-minute speech from applicant's NECC professor was entertained, yet neighbors who own property and will have effects on

their quality of life were not allowed to speak. The applicant's talent is absolutely irrelevant to the issue of this application and should not be considered.

If by some stretch of imagination this was argument that Haverhill is lacking in culinary places to dine, we think the majority of the restaurant owners in downtown Haverhill would take issue. Likewise, those with function halls would argue there are plenty of places to hold baby showers. If someone is looking to pitch a tent for an event, within just a few miles is the lovely non-profit site of John Greenleaf Whittier's birthplace. Or looking for a charming place to have a wedding, the non-profit East Parish Meeting house just a couple miles away currently has a sign advertising such. It is not to the benefit of the city to take another home out of the already low housing stock and redirect commercial traffic away from the downtown area, where it is zoned and welcomed.

F. Functions such as Tea Room, etc. are Not Permitted in Rural Residential Zone

Further to the point of the City not lacking in restaurants and other places to have functions, Zoning has already been well-defined and created to promote these types of functions primarily in the Commercial zones. Encouraging these businesses to locate in a central area promotes increased foot traffic and exposure for the other businesses which creates a thriving business community. Having people come out to a rural residential area does nothing to promote that environment. If the applicants want to run a function hall or tea room, let them do so in the properly zoned area.

Even more to this point, exactly WHAT do those functions have to do with a Bed-and-Breakfast? Nowhere could we find that functions such as these things are permitted in the Rural Residential zone. We do not find that the City Council is within the authority to grant them. If our research is correct, they are therefore not allowed and should be removed entirely from the scope of whatever may be permitted under this application.

G. Consideration for Priority Habitat of Rare Species

A portion of the property at 421 East Broadway is zoned as "Priority Habitat of Rare Species" by the NHESP (National Heritage & Endangered Species Program). Any habitat alteration cannot occur without official review. The MESA Massachusetts Endangered Species Act strictly prohibits the "take" (which includes disrupting or degrading nesting/breeding habitat). Any proposed project, clearing, or construction inside this zone must be filed directly with NHESP Regulatory Review unless specifically exempt. The noise from a gathering of people could be considered a "take". While applicant appears to concede to conditions of keeping events indoors and complying with city noise standards, the noise standards for species are completely species-dependent. They should likewise concede that they will present any activities to NHESP for review and that their special permit would be revoked should they be found to be in violation.

Let us finish by restating some of the things mentioned in person at the last meeting. You are on a slippery slope as the Council if you permit any variation to the actual definition of B&B. You will open yourself up to challenges by other individuals who want similar concessions. While some of you, or perhaps all of you, think this B&B is quaint and would love to see it in the city, the next project that doesn't meet the definitions may not be to your liking. You'll be hard pressed to justify how you could deviate from the legal definitions in one case but not in another. Do not set this precedent.

All property owners purchase their properties with the knowledge of what activities are or are not going to be permitted where they live. They look to the Council to protect our right to peaceful enjoyment and protection of our investment. If we had wanted to "live free or die" we would have moved to New Hampshire. We didn't. We chose to live in Haverhill because we agree with the laws and zoning it has established. Please protect those.

Further, this applicant, we believe, never had any intention of even coming to you for a permit except they got "caught". They hung a sign. They are on Google maps. Please do not reward this type of "don't ask permission, do it and beg forgiveness" mentality.

You have every right to deny this application for failure to meet the definition of a B&B. You do not have authority to grant permission for this hotel.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Lisa Onyon

John McCutcheon

Lori Robertson

From: Lisa Mead <lisa@mtclawyers.com>
Sent: Monday, July 27, 2026 3:12 PM
To: Lori Robertson
Cc: Devan Ferreira; Tim Jordan; Tim Jordan
Subject: Re: City Council Meeting July 28, 2026 agenda item 421 East Broadway

Warning: External Email. Exercise caution when opening attachments or clicking on any links.

Councilor Ferrerira,

The answer is yes, the Council has a right to attach conditions to a Special Permit if they overcome any deficiencies in the opinion of the Council relative to the applicable criteria. Here the general Special Permit criteria are as follows:

10.4.2, "[i]n addition to any specific factors that may be set forth in th[e] [zoning] chapter, such determination shall include consideration of each of the following:

1. Community needs served by the proposal;
2. Traffic and pedestrian flow and safety, including parking and loading;
3. Adequacy of utilities and other public services;
4. Neighborhood character and social structures;
5. Impacts on the natural environment; and
6. Potential fiscal impact, including impact on City services, tax base, and employment."

Your proposed limitations on where the activities may take place are directly related to number 4. Above. So a motion would include something like:

Move that the Application meets the criteria in section 10.4.2 conditioned upon the following conditions being included in the special permit:

- 1.
 - 2.
 - 3.
- Etc.

The council needs to make a finding related to each criteria, and in doing so may add the conditions.

Please let me know if that answers your questions.

Regards,

Lisa
Lisa L. Mead
[she/her/hers]



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♻️ Think before you print.

From: Lori Robertson <lrobertson@haverhillma.gov>
Sent: Monday, July 27, 2026 12:23 PM
To: Lisa Mead <lisa@mtclawyers.com>
Cc: Devan Ferreira <DFerreira@haverhillma.gov>; Tim Jordan <tjjordan94@gmail.com>; Tim Jordan <tjordan@haverhillma.gov>
Subject: FW: City Council Meeting July 28, 2026 agenda item 421 East Broadway

Hi Lisa!

Councilor Ferreira has another question in regard to the email from Lisa Onyon. Please see the email below from Councilor Ferreira.

Thank you,
Lori

Lori A. Robertson
Administrative Assistant
Haverhill City Council
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From: Devan Ferreira <DFerreira@haverhillma.gov>
Sent: Monday, July 27, 2026 12:18 PM
To: Lori Robertson <lrobertson@haverhillma.gov>; Tim Jordan <tjordan@haverhillma.gov>
Subject: Fw: City Council Meeting July 28, 2026 agenda item 421 East Broadway

Can we ask Lisa Mead's opinion on the proposed conditions in this email and mentioned at previous hearing?

Specifically: is limiting outdoor activity at this proposed B&B to within the "envelope" of the building, or stricter noise ordinance requirements over reaching appropriate/legal conditions?

Please let me know if I should reach out to Lisa myself?
Devan Ferreira